COPILOT

MICROSOFT 365

COURSE SLIDES · WSQ

Microsoft Copilot for Content Creation and Task Automation

WSQ Course Code: TGS-2024042588

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN 201200696W

Version v1.0 · 1 September 2026

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1. Trainer displays the SSG digital attendance QR code
2. Scan it with your phone camera
3. Submit your attendance
4. Repeat AM, PM and on assessment day

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About the Trainer



Your Trainer

General Trainer template —
to be completed by the trainer

NAME

TITLE / DESIGNATION

QUALIFICATIONS

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

TRAINING & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

CONTACT

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YOUR TRAINER

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer
Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

ROLE
Principal Trainer, Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

CERTIFICATION
Microsoft certified — Power Platform, Microsoft 365 and AI solutions.

DELIVERS
WSQ courses on Microsoft Copilot, Power Automate and automation.

FOUNDER
Founder and lead instructor at Tertiary Infotech / Tertiary Courses.

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ICE-BREAKER

Let's Know Each Other

1

Who you are

Your name, your organisation and the role you play in it.

2

What you repeat

The task you find yourself redoing most often each week.

3

What you want back

The hours you would reclaim if that task ran itself.

4

Where you want to get to

What you want to automate or produce faster after this week.

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HOUSEKEEPING

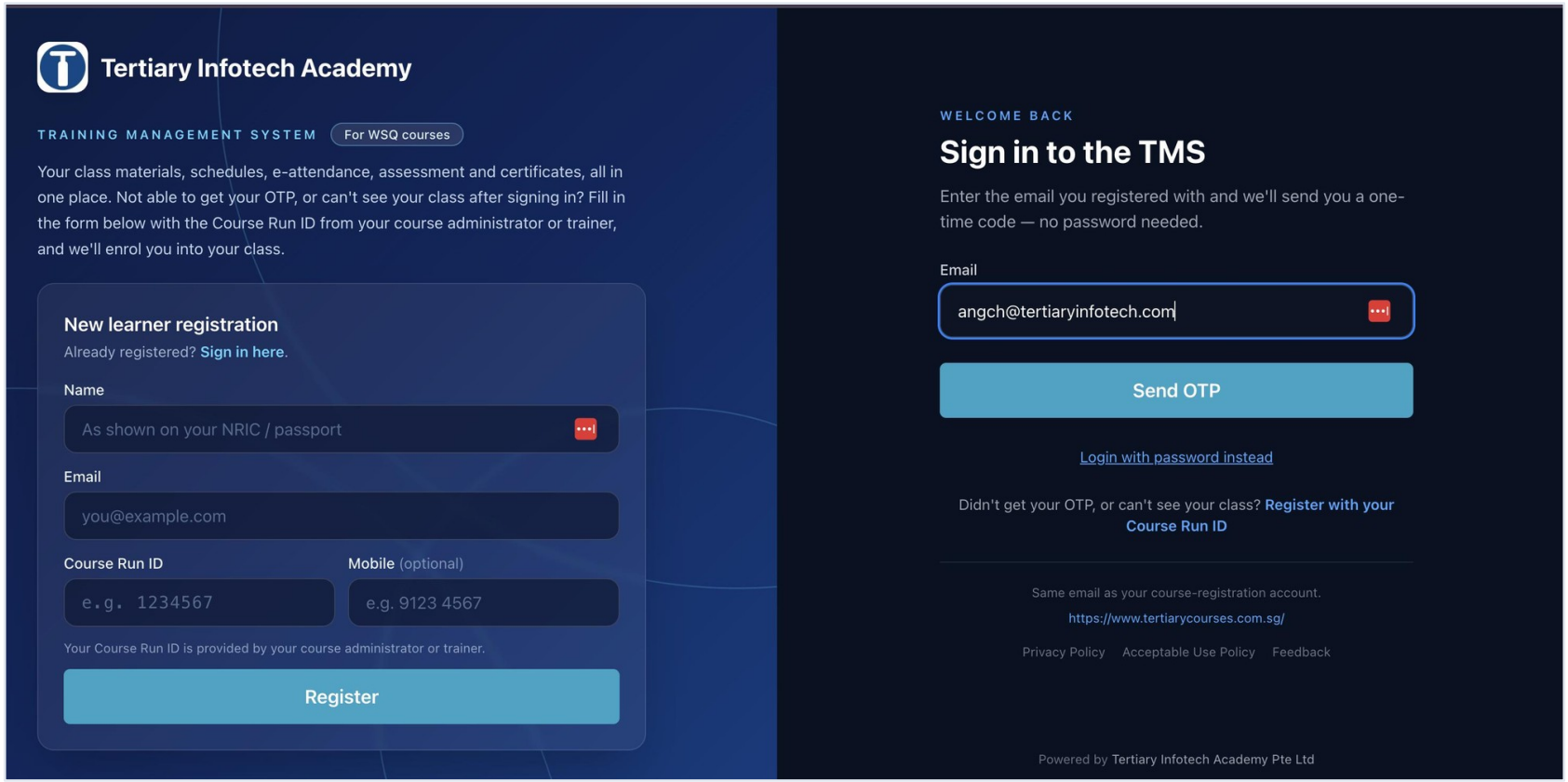
Ground Rules

1. Set your mobile phone to silent mode.
2. Participate actively — no question is too small.
3. Mutual respect: agree to disagree.
4. One conversation at a time.
5. Be punctual; return from breaks on time.
6. 75% attendance is required.

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COURSE PORTAL

Login to LMS and Download Course Material



Log in at lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com with your registered email and the OTP sent to your inbox, then open this course to download the slides and Learner Guide.

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COURSE REPOSITORY

Download Your Course Material

1

LMS / TMS portal

lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com — sign in with the account issued to you.

2

Trainer slides

The deck used in class, as a PDF for reference.

3

Learner Guide

Every lab's full step-by-step procedure and prompts.

4

Lab files

Each lab folder holds its own data and instruction PDF.

5

Lesson Plan

The daily schedule and what is covered when.

6

Open book

You may use these materials during the assessment.

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LEARNING OUTCOMES

What You Will Achieve

1

Copilot for content

Produce verified business content in Word, PowerPoint, Excel and Outlook.

2

Feasibility scanning

Identify which work is worth automating, and what it would take.

3

Power Automate

Build flows that integrate Forms, Outlook, Excel and Approvals.

4

Copilot Studio agents

Design, ground, tool and publish agents that behave.

5

Integration

Connect automation to other systems over HTTP with a schema.

6

Testing and governance

Verify behaviour, gate consequential actions and diagnose failures.

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WSQ COURSE OUTCOMES

Learning Outcomes

1

LO1

Identify opportunities and perform feasibility scans for dataverse and Power App applications.

2

LO2

Utilise Business Flow and Power Automate to integrate functions across programs with API-level integration.

3

LO3

Execute tests in Power Virtual Agent and Power BI to verify their functioning across platforms.

4

LO4

Implement modifications to Power Platform with Power AI Builder and highlight technical issues.

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SCHEDULE

Lesson Plan — 5 Days, 8 Hours a Day

1

Day 1 — Copilot Foundations, Word and PowerPoint

Topic 01 · Labs 01–05

2

Day 2 — Copilot for Excel and Outlook

Topic 02 · Labs 06–10

3

Day 3 — Business Process Automation with Power Automate

Topic 03 · Labs 11–15

4

Day 4 — Copilot Studio Agents

Topic 04 · Labs 16–20

5

Day 5 — Integration, Testing, Security and Assessment

Topic 05 · Labs 21–25 + Assessment

6

Daily timing

9:30am–6:30pm · 1-hour lunch · tea breaks within

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ONE STORY, TWENTY-FIVE LABS

The Course Scenario

1

Lumina Living Pte Ltd

A Singapore workspace-furniture company.

2

The Sustainable Workspace campaign

One connected scenario across all 25 labs.

3

Day 1–2

You create and verify the campaign's content.

4

Day 3–5

You automate the process behind it and put agents on it.

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BEFORE ASSESSMENT

Briefing for Assessment

1

Phones away

Place phones and other materials under the table or on the floor.

2

No recording

No photos or recording of assessment scripts, at any point.

3

No discussion

Work individually — no discussion once the assessment starts.

4

Black or blue pen

Use a black or blue pen for any hard-copy assessment.

5

No correction fluid

No liquid paper or correction tape; strike through instead.

6

Time is called

Scripts are collected when time is up — submit before then.

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FINAL ASSESSMENT

Assessment

	Written Assessment (WA)	Practical Performance (PP)
Format	Short-answer questions (SAQ)	Hands-on practical tasks
What it tests	Underpinning knowledge K1-K5	Practical ability A1-A8
Duration	1 hour	1 hour
Conditions	Open book, individual	Open book, individual
Submission	On the LMS	On the LMS, with evidence

RULE Open book: slides, Learner Guide and your completed lab files. 75% attendance is required; a re-assessment and appeal process is available.

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow

1. TRAQOM survey — scan the QR code on the LMS
2. Assessment digital attendance — scan the SSG QR
3. Sit WA (SAQ) then PP — open book
4. Submit your answers on the LMS
5. Sign the Assessment Summary Record

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01

TOPIC 01

Copilot Foundations and Content Creation in Word and PowerPoint

Grounding · responsible use · prompt design · drafting · presentation storytelling

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DAY 1 · WHAT THIS TOPIC COVERS

Key Concepts — Topic 01

1. Microsoft 365 Copilot combines your prompt with permitted work context; existing access permissions always still apply.
2. The prompt contract states the goal, the context, the source and the expected output format, then verifies the result.
3. Copilot proposes and the user disposes: the human checks evidence, tone, sensitivity and final release.
4. Word turns approved evidence into a structured narrative; a reference document keeps the draft anchored to fact.
5. PowerPoint converts an approved narrative into a decision-led story with one message per slide.
6. Responsible AI principles — fairness, reliability, privacy, inclusiveness, transparency and accountability — govern every use.

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WHAT YOU WILL DO

Hands-On Labs — Topic 01

Labs 01–02

- Set Up Microsoft 365 Copilot and Prompt Safely
- Draft a Project Brief in Word from Excel Evidence

Labs 03–04

- Refine a Responsible Copilot Use Policy in Word
- Build a PowerPoint Story from Word and Excel

Labs 05–05

- Enhance PowerPoint with Native Charts and Speaker Notes

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THE WORK SYSTEM

What Microsoft 365 Copilot Actually Is

1

An interface

Chat and in-app experiences accept a goal written in natural language.

2

A model

A large language model generates, transforms and summarises content.

3

Your work context

Permitted files, mail, chats and meetings can ground the answer.

4

The apps

Word, PowerPoint, Excel, Outlook and Teams embed task-specific assistance.

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GROUNDING

How a Grounded Answer Is Produced



WHY IT MATTERS Copilot never widens your access. If you could not open the file yourself, Copilot cannot use it for you.

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KNOW WHICH SURFACE YOU ARE ON

Web Grounding vs Work Grounding

Aspect	Web / Chat	Work (Microsoft 365)
Sources	Public web content	Your permitted tenant content
Permissions	Not applicable	Your existing access applies
Best for	General drafting and research	Anything about your own business
Risk	No business context	Answer is only as good as the source

RULE Check the toggle before you trust an answer about your own organisation.

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HOW TO ASK

The Four-Part Prompt Contract

1

Goal

What you want produced, stated as an outcome.

2

Context

Who it is for and why it matters.

3

Source

The file, data or thread the answer must come from.

4

Expectation

Length, format, tone and what must not be invented.

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BEFORE AND AFTER

A Weak Prompt and a Strong Prompt

Weak

- "Write something about our campaign."
  - No goal beyond a topic
  - No source, so nothing is grounded
  - No format, so the shape is a guess
  - Nothing stated as off-limits

Strong

- "Draft a two-page brief for the leadership team"
  - "using the attached workbook and template,"
  - "with three measurable objectives and risks,"
  - "and mark anything unevidenced as an open question."
  - Every part of the contract is present

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THE HUMAN DUTY

Copilot proposes. You dispose.

The model produces a draft. Accountability for what is released never moves.

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DECISION RULE

Can I Release This Output?



YES

- Release it, recording who verified it
- Keep the evidence with the artifact

NO

- Correct it, or mark it an open question
- Never publish an unevidenced claim as fact

RULE A claim that cannot be traced is not a finding — it is a guess with good grammar.

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SIX PRINCIPLES

Responsible AI in Practice

1

Fairness

Check that outputs do not disadvantage a group.

2

Reliability and safety

Test behaviour, including the failure cases.

3

Privacy and security

Existing data protection duties still apply.

4

Inclusiveness

Content should be usable by everyone who needs it.

5

Transparency

Say when and how AI was used.

6

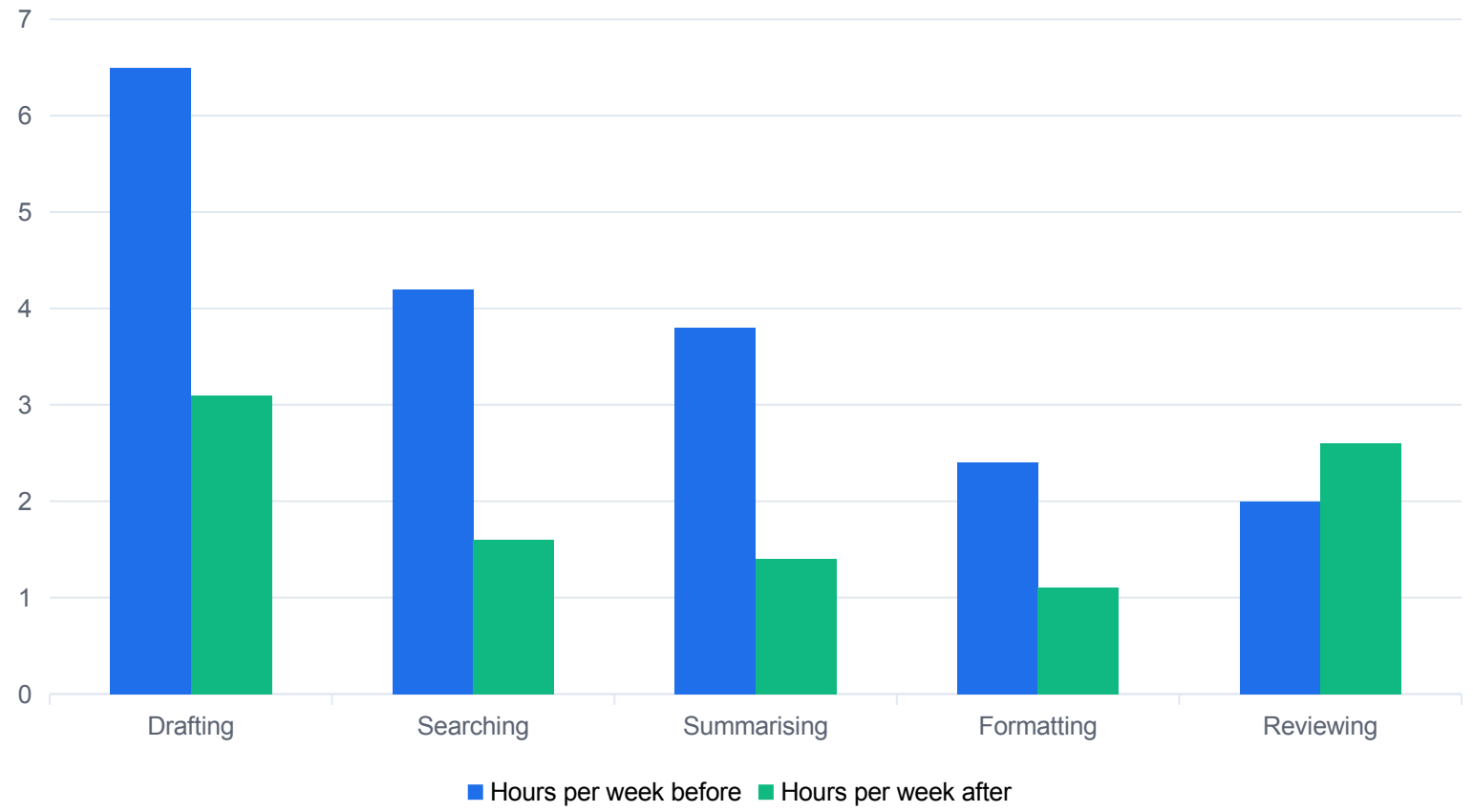
Accountability

A named person answers for what is released.

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NATIVE CHART

Where the Time Actually Goes



DECISION LENS

Drafting and searching fall the most. Review time rises — and that is the point, not a defect.

? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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DRAFT AND REFINE

Copilot in Word

1

Draft from a source

Generate a first draft grounded in a reference file.

2

Rewrite

Change tone, length or reading level without losing the facts.

3

Summarise

Reduce a long document to its decisions and obligations.

4

Ask about the document

Interrogate a draft rather than re-reading it.

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WORD WORKFLOW

From Evidence to an Approved Document



WHY IT MATTERS The template is what stops a good draft becoming the wrong document.

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TELL THE STORY

Copilot in PowerPoint

1

Build from a document

Turn an approved brief into a slide structure.

2

Outline first

Fix the story before any slide is generated.

3

One message per slide

The title states the takeaway, not the topic.

4

Speaker notes

Draft what to say, then check it against the slide.

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STATE THE TAKEAWAY

Slide Title Styles

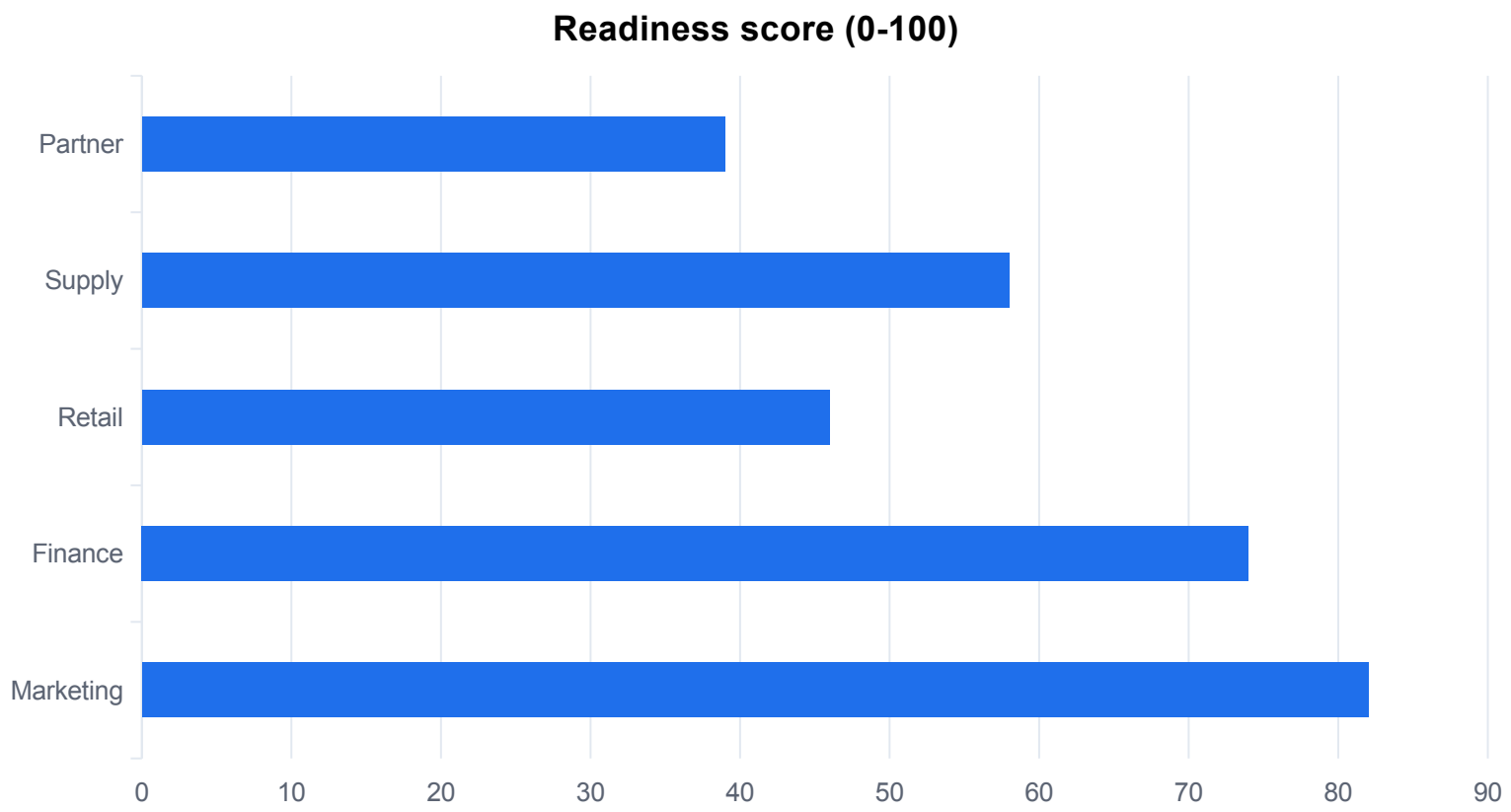
	Topic title (weak)	Takeaway title (strong)
Performance	"Q3 Results"	"Revenue grew 12%, but margin fell"
Risk	"Risks"	"Stock lead time is the only launch blocker"
Ask	"Next Steps"	"We need budget approval by 19 September"

RULE If the audience reads only your titles, they should still get the argument.

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NATIVE CHART

Adoption Readiness Is Uneven



DECISION LENS

Clustered bars expose the control gap before rollout. Train where readiness is lowest.

? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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THE LIMITS

What Copilot Cannot Do For You

1

Know what it was not given

An unattached source cannot be used.

2

Guarantee a number is right

Every figure needs checking against the source.

3

Take accountability

The named human approver still owns the output.

4

Understand your politics

Tone and sensitivity are your judgement, not its.

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Tea Break

10 minutes

THE SURFACES

Where You Meet Copilot

1

Copilot Chat

A standalone conversation, with or without work grounding.

2

In-app Copilot

Inside Word, PowerPoint, Excel, Outlook and Teams.

3

Copilot in the flow of work

Summaries and suggestions offered where you already are.

4

Agents

Purpose-built assistants for a specific job — Days 4 and 5.

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FAILURE MODES

Three Ways a Draft Can Be Wrong

Failure	What it looks like	How you catch it
Invention	A confident fact that is not in any source	Trace every claim to a cell or section
Omission	A true summary that leaves out the caveat	Read the source, not only the summary
Misframing	Accurate numbers arranged to imply the wrong thing	Ask what decision the reader would make

RULE Invention is the famous one. Omission and misframing cause more harm in practice.

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WHAT COPILOT CAN USE

Grounding Sources You Can Attach

1

A file

A workbook, document or deck you reference directly.

2

A meeting

A recorded or transcribed meeting you attended.

3

A mail thread

Messages in a mailbox you have access to.

4

A site or library

A SharePoint location you are permitted to read.

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DECISION RULE

Is This Task a Good Fit for Copilot?



YES

- Draft with Copilot, then verify against that source
- Record the source in your evidence register

NO

- Do the thinking first, then use Copilot to express it
- Never ask it to supply facts you do not have

RULE Copilot is excellent at expressing what you know. It is unreliable at knowing what you do not.

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FOUR QUESTIONS

Reading a Copilot Answer Critically

1

What is it citing?

If nothing, treat every fact as unverified.

2

What did it leave out?

Compare against the source, not against your expectation.

3

What would change my mind?

Name the evidence that would falsify the claim.

4

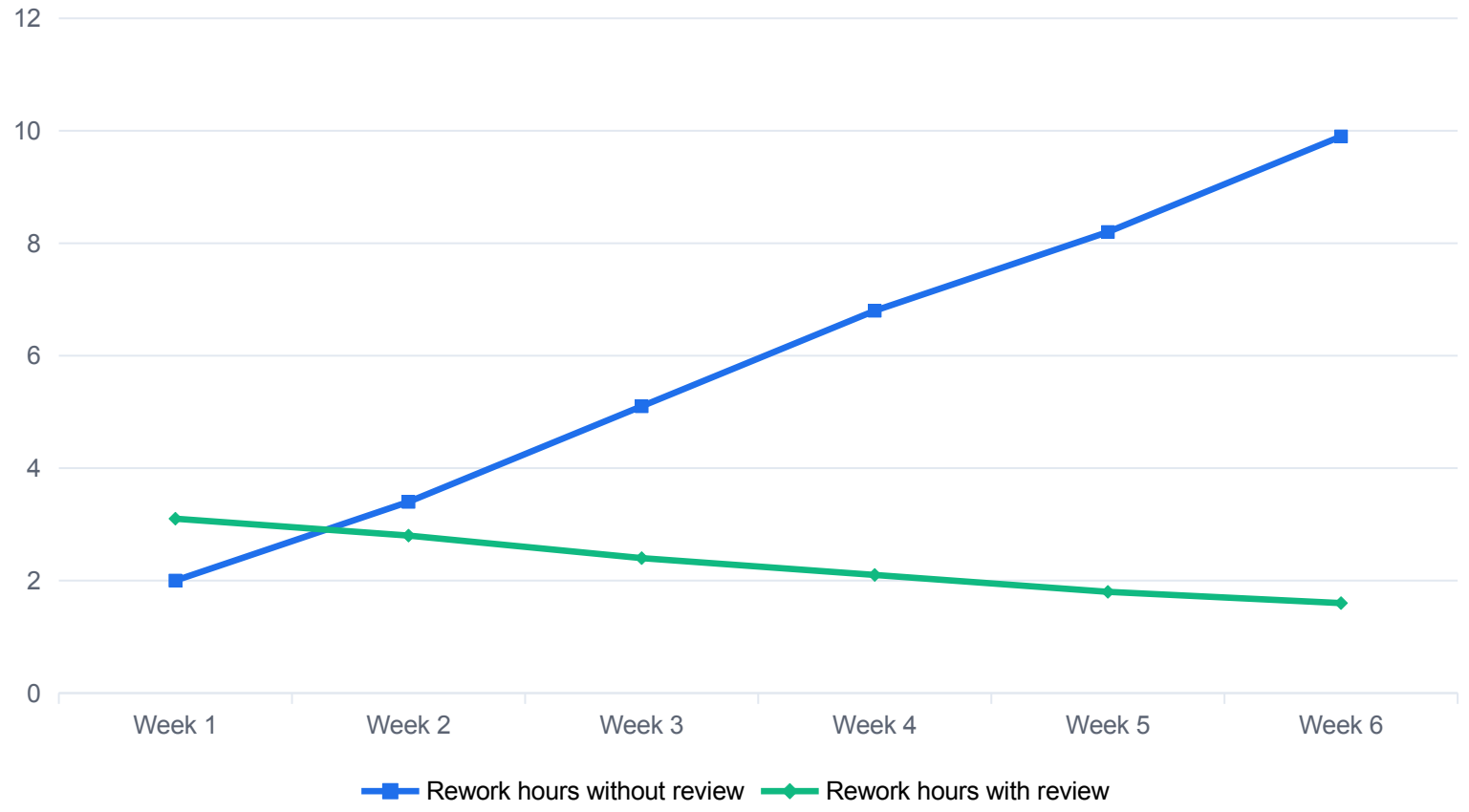
Who is accountable?

Someone must be named before this is released.

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NATIVE CHART

Verification Effort Pays Back



DECISION LENS

Review costs more in week one and less in every week after. Unverified output compounds.

? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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BEFORE YOU SHARE

Making a Deck Accessible

1

Contrast

Text must be readable against its background.

2

Type size

If it needs squinting on a projector, it is too small.

3

Alt text

Every meaningful image and chart needs a description.

4

Reading order

Screen readers follow the object order, not the visual layout.

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TOPIC 01 · FOUNDATION

Set Up Microsoft 365 Copilot and Prompt Safely

LAB 01 K1 · A1

The learner confirms which Copilot surface they are licensed for, learns how grounding and permissions work, writes prompts using the four-part prompt contract, and records a review decision for every generated claim.

You will build

A completed setup, grounding and prompt-review register in Excel

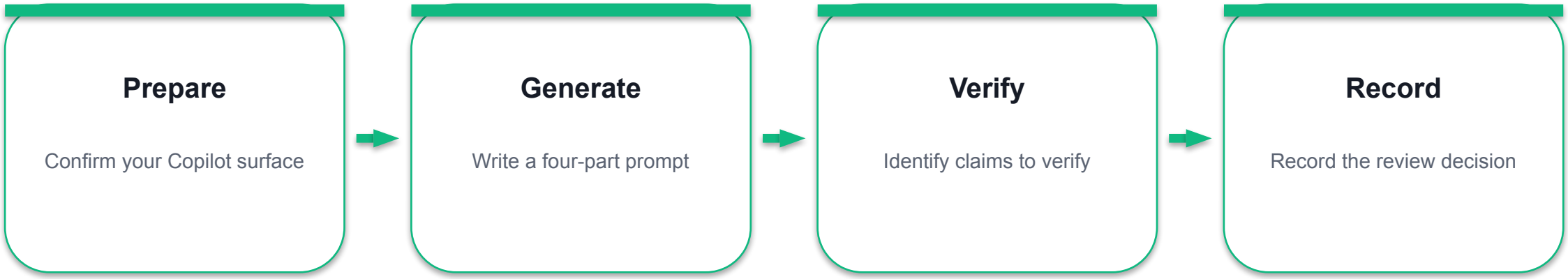
Apps: Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat, Excel

ASSESSED	LEVEL	EVIDENCE
K1 · A1	Foundation	Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 01 · PROCESS

How Lab 01 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 01) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 01 · ACCEPTANCE

Set Up Microsoft 365 Copilot and Prompt Safely

✅ Acceptance check

The register identifies the active Copilot surface, the grounding source, three evidence-backed gaps, and a verification status for every claim.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 01 · FOUNDATION

Draft a Project Brief in Word from Excel Evidence

LAB 02 K2 · A2

The learner uses Copilot in Word with a supplied template and workbook to draft a two-page launch brief, then traces every objective, milestone, risk and number back to the workbook.

You will build

A two-page launch brief with cited objectives, milestones, risks and open questions

Apps: Word, Excel, Copilot

ASSESSED K2 · A2

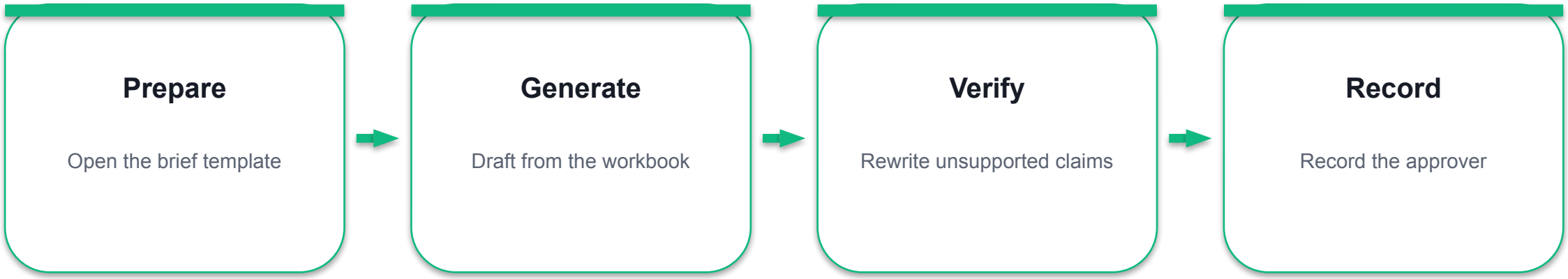
LEVEL Foundation

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 02 · PROCESS

How Lab 02 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 02) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 02 · ACCEPTANCE

Draft a Project Brief in Word from Excel Evidence

✅ Acceptance check

The brief fills every template heading, all figures trace to the workbook, and unsupported statements appear as open questions rather than claims.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 01 · INTERMEDIATE

Refine a Responsible Copilot Use Policy in Word

LAB 03 K1 · A2

The learner reviews a draft internal policy with Copilot, identifies gaps and ambiguities, rewrites the weak clauses, and produces a one-page staff quick-reference from the approved text.

You will build

An approved policy draft, an issue log and a staff quick-reference checklist

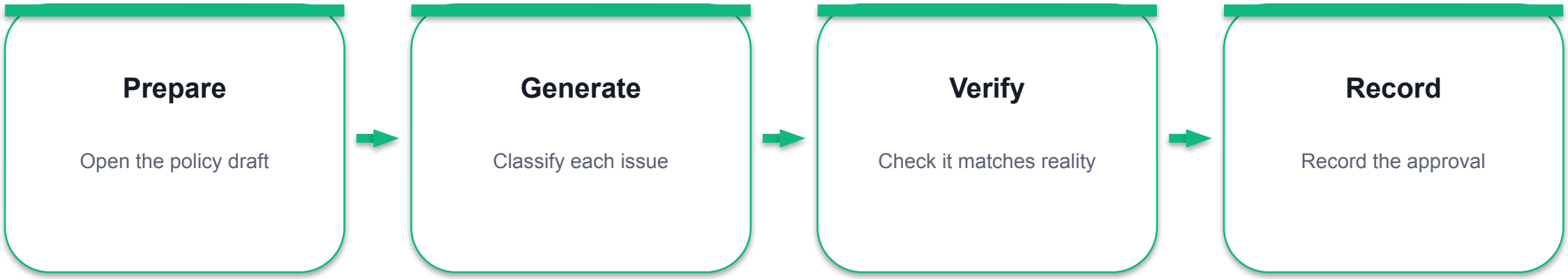
Apps: Word, Excel, Copilot

ASSESSED	LEVEL	EVIDENCE
K1 · A2	Intermediate	Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 03 · PROCESS

How Lab 03 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 03) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 03 · ACCEPTANCE

Refine a Responsible Copilot Use Policy in Word

✅ Acceptance check

Every logged issue has a decision and a rationale, the rewritten policy keeps its defined terms, and the quick-reference matches the approved text.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 01 · INTERMEDIATE

Build a PowerPoint Story from Word and Excel

LAB 04 K2 · A2

The learner generates a leadership deck from the approved brief and workbook, checks every claim against its source, and ends the deck with a specific decision request.

You will build

An eight-slide leadership deck with one message per slide and a documented evidence map

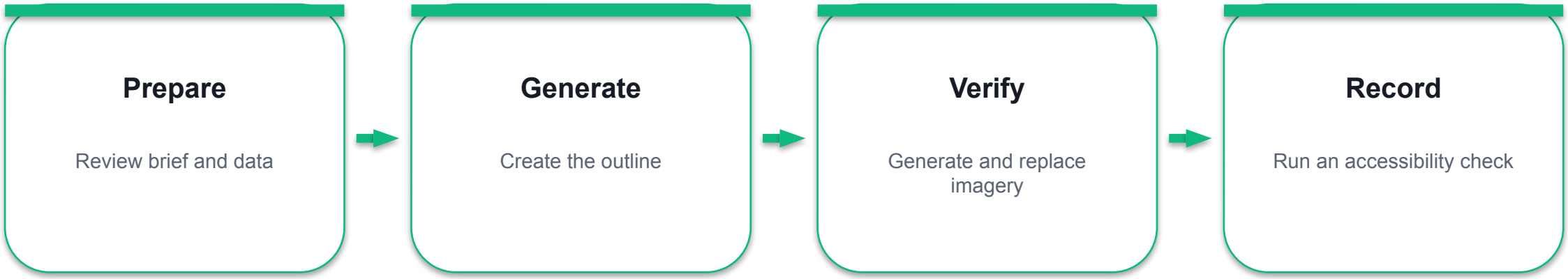
Apps: PowerPoint, Word, Excel, Copilot

ASSESSED K2 · A2	**LEVEL** Intermediate	**EVIDENCE** Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 04 · PROCESS

How Lab 04 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 04) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 04 · ACCEPTANCE

Build a PowerPoint Story from Word and Excel

✅ Acceptance check

The deck contains eight coherent slides, all quantitative claims trace to the workbook, and the final slide asks for a specific decision.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 01 · INTERMEDIATE

Enhance PowerPoint with Native Charts and Speaker Notes

LAB 05 K2 · A2

The learner replaces picture-charts with native editable PowerPoint charts driven by the workbook, then generates and verifies speaker notes that match what each chart actually shows.

You will build

A polished deck with native trend, contribution and variance charts plus verified speaker notes

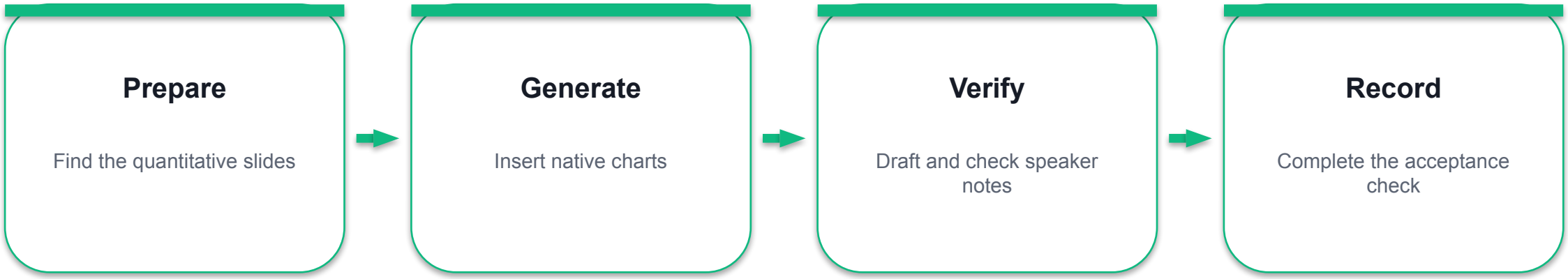
Apps: PowerPoint, Excel, Copilot

ASSESSED	LEVEL	EVIDENCE
K2 · A2	Intermediate	Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 05 · PROCESS

How Lab 05 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 05) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 05 · ACCEPTANCE

Enhance PowerPoint with Native Charts and Speaker Notes

✅ Acceptance check

Every data slide carries a native, labelled chart traceable to the workbook, and each speaker note states only what its chart actually shows.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

Recap — Topic 01

1

Lab 01

Identify where Copilot is available, how it is grounded, and the verification duty that comes with it

2

Lab 02

Produce a governed business document in Word grounded in an approved data source

3

Lab 03

Use Copilot to review, improve and simplify an existing governance document

4

Lab 04

Convert an approved brief and supporting data into a decision-led presentation

5

Lab 05

Turn a draft deck into a presentation-ready story with verifiable native charts

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End of Day 1

See you tomorrow

02

TOPIC 02

Copilot for Excel and Outlook: Analysis and Communication

Analysis-ready data · formulas · diagnostics · forecasting · inbox triage · controlled replies

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DAY 2 · WHAT THIS TOPIC COVERS

Key Concepts — Topic 02

1. Copilot analyses an Excel Table with one header row, one record per row and consistent data types.
2. Analysis progresses from descriptive to diagnostic, then predictive and prescriptive questions.
3. A suggested formula is a proposal: check its logic, references and edge cases before you accept it.
4. Scenario modelling separates assumptions from formulas so base, downside and upside cases can be compared.
5. Outlook Copilot triages a mailbox, summarises a thread and drafts a reply, but a person always sends it.
6. Every quantitative claim must trace back to a named sheet and cell range before it is used in a decision.

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WHAT YOU WILL DO

Hands-On Labs — Topic 02

Labs 06–07

- Build and Audit Excel Formulas with Copilot
- Run Deep Descriptive and Diagnostic Analysis in Excel

Labs 08–09

- Forecast and Stress-Test a Campaign with Copilot
- Triage an Outlook Inbox and Draft a Controlled Reply

Labs 10–10

- Turn Meeting Notes into an Action Register

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BEFORE YOU ASK

What Makes Data Analysis-Ready

1

One header row

A single, clear name for every column.

2

One record per row

No merged cells and no stacked sub-tables.

3

Consistent types

A number column holds numbers, not text like 'n/a'.

4

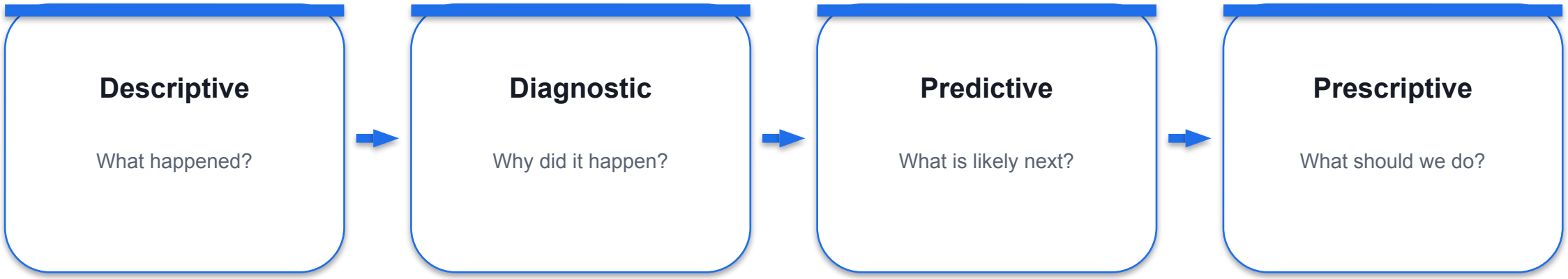
An Excel Table

Structured references that survive inserted rows.

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PROGRESSIVE ANALYSIS

The Four Analytical Questions



WHY IT MATTERS Asking a prescriptive question of data you have not described yet produces confident nonsense.

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CHART SELECTION

Choosing the Honest Chart

The question	Chart type	Why
Trend over time	Line	Ordered time on a continuous axis
Comparison across groups	Bar or column	Length is easy to compare
Contribution to a total	Stacked bar or sorted bar	Shows the parts and the whole
Relationship between two measures	Scatter	Shows correlation and outliers

RULE The question chooses the chart. Preference does not.

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NEVER ACCEPT BLIND

Auditing a Generated Formula

1

Read the logic

Does it compute what you actually asked for?

2

Check the references

Right column, right table, absolute where needed.

3

Test the edge cases

Zero, blank, negative and text values.

4

Confirm the rounding

Rounding at the wrong step changes a total.

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FORMULA DISCIPLINE

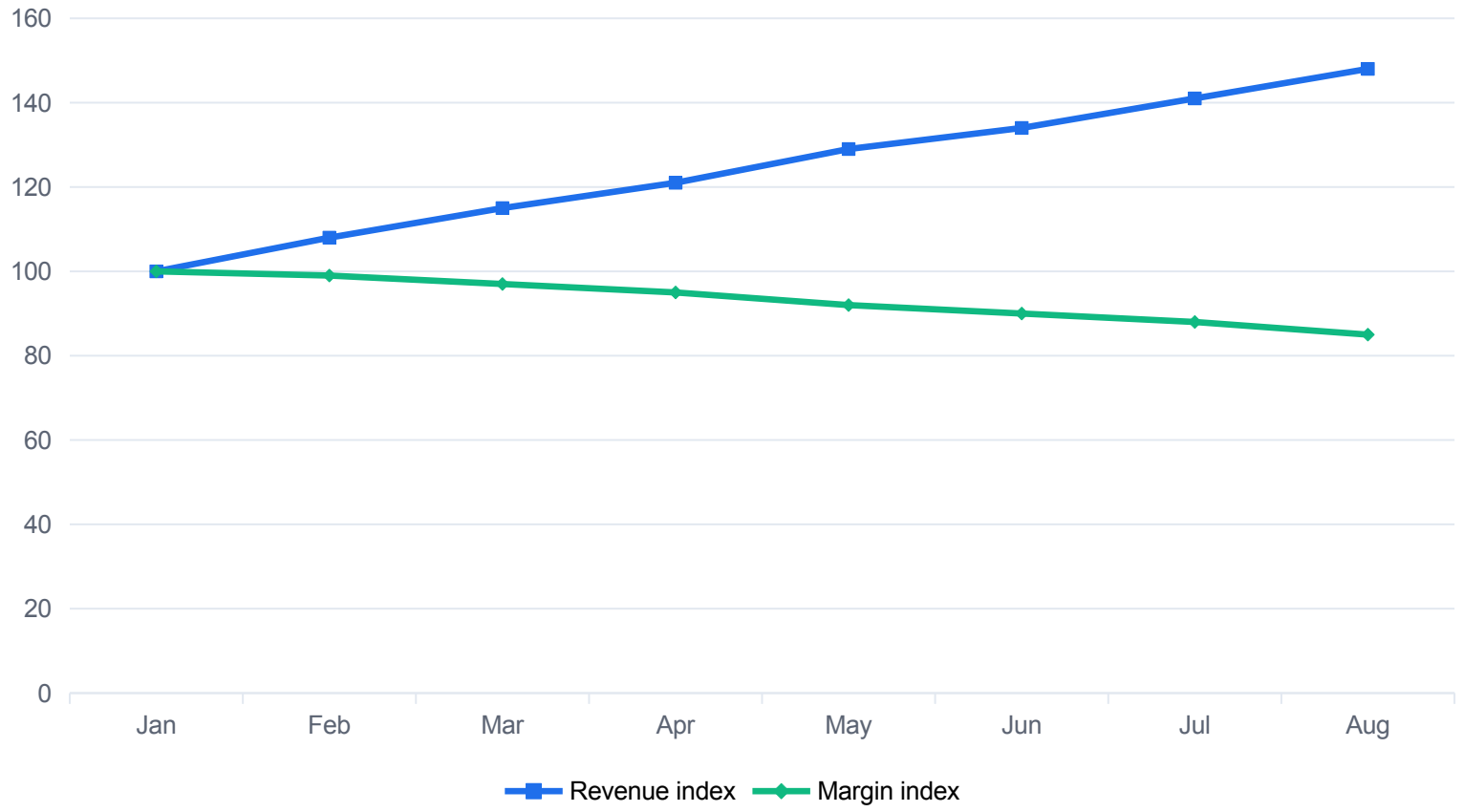
A formula you did not check is a number you cannot defend.

Copilot writes the formula in seconds. Auditing it is the part that makes it yours.

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NATIVE CHART

Revenue Grows While Margin Tightens



DECISION LENS

Two series tell the real story: growth alone would have looked like success.

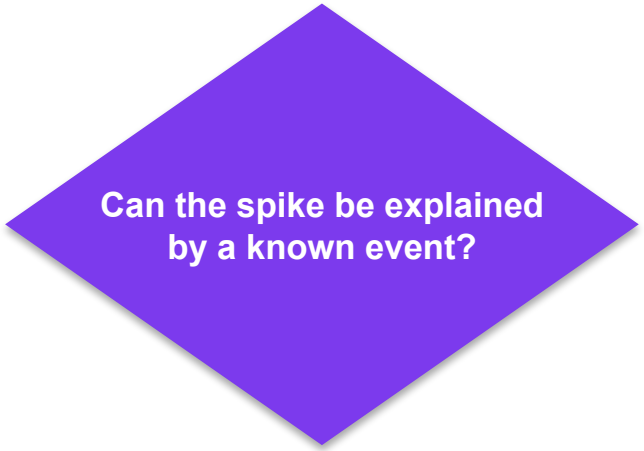
? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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DECISION RULE

Is This an Anomaly or a Signal?



YES

- Annotate it and keep it in the analysis
- Record the explanation as evidence

NO

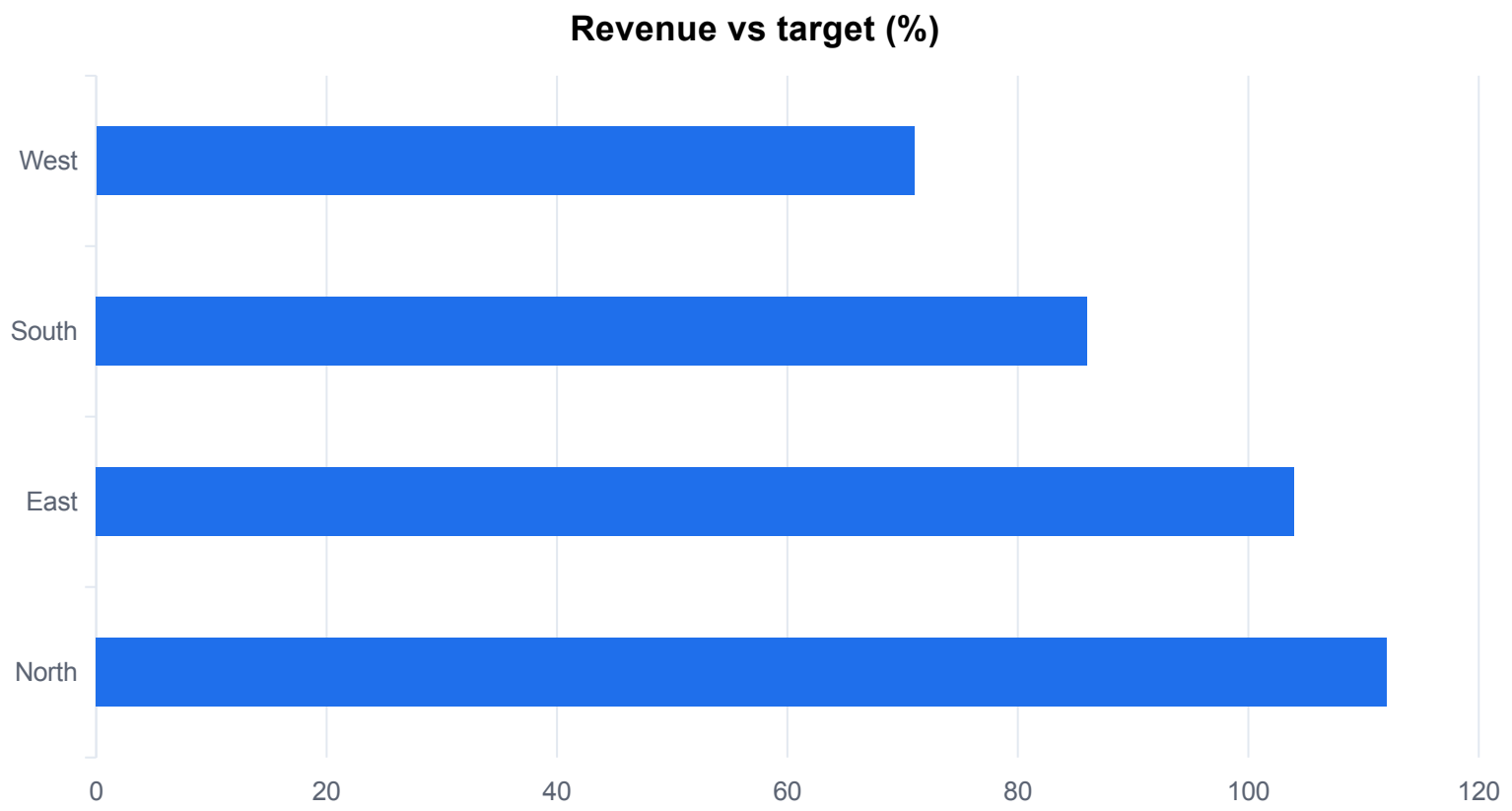
- Log it in the anomaly register
- Investigate before it drives a decision

RULE An unexplained outlier is a question, not a data-entry error to be quietly deleted.

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NATIVE CHART

Where the Revenue Gap Sits



DECISION LENS

Two regions carry the shortfall. The average concealed both of them.

? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

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BASE, DOWNSIDE, UPSIDE

Scenario Modelling Rules

1

Assumptions live in one place

Every driver is a labelled cell, never a typed constant.

2

Formulas reference assumptions

Changing a scenario changes cells, not formulas.

3

Scenarios differ only by inputs

If a scenario needs new logic, the model is wrong.

4

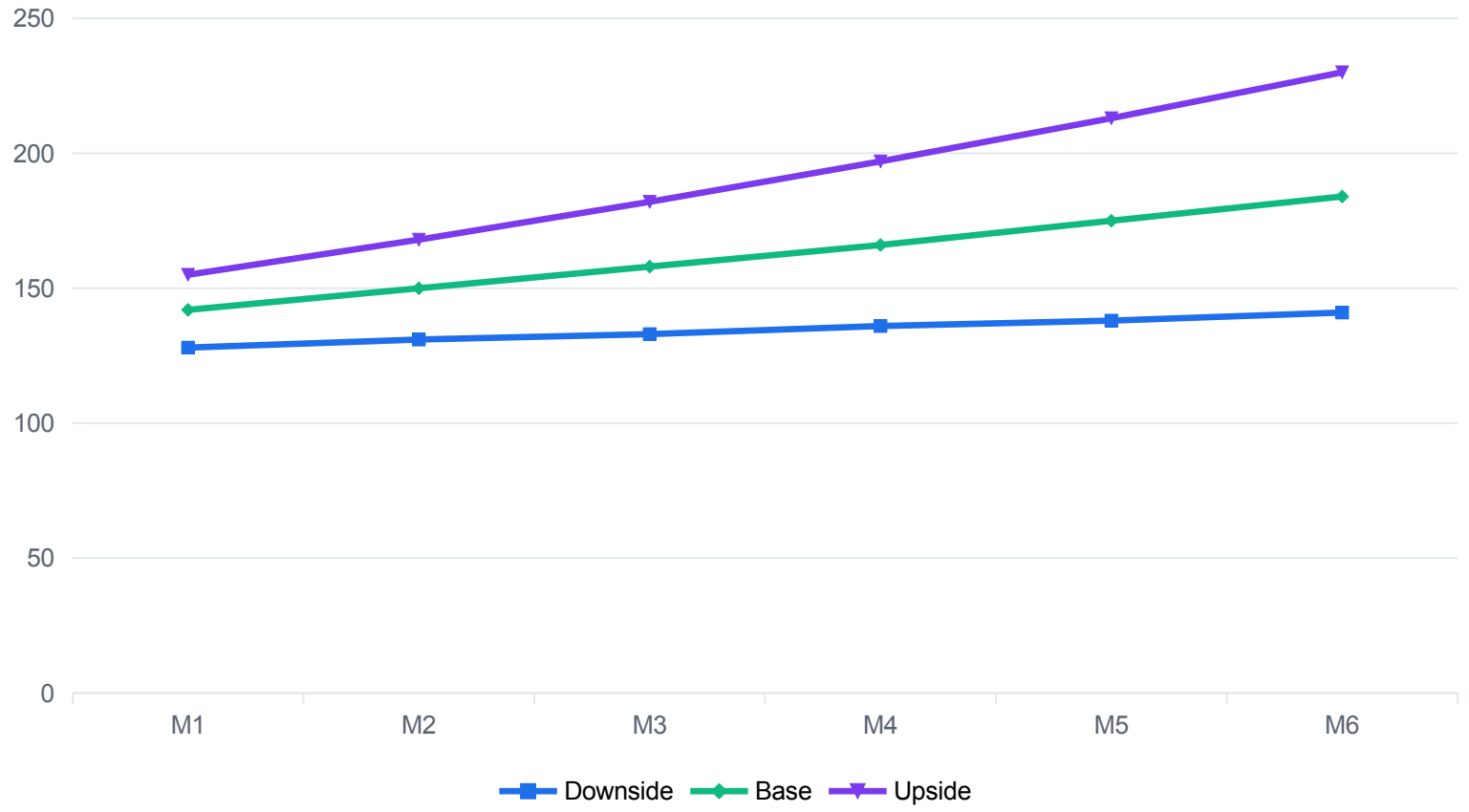
State the limits

Say when the forecast stops being valid.

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NATIVE CHART

Forecast Range, Not a Single Number



DECISION LENS

Presenting one line implies a precision the model does not have.

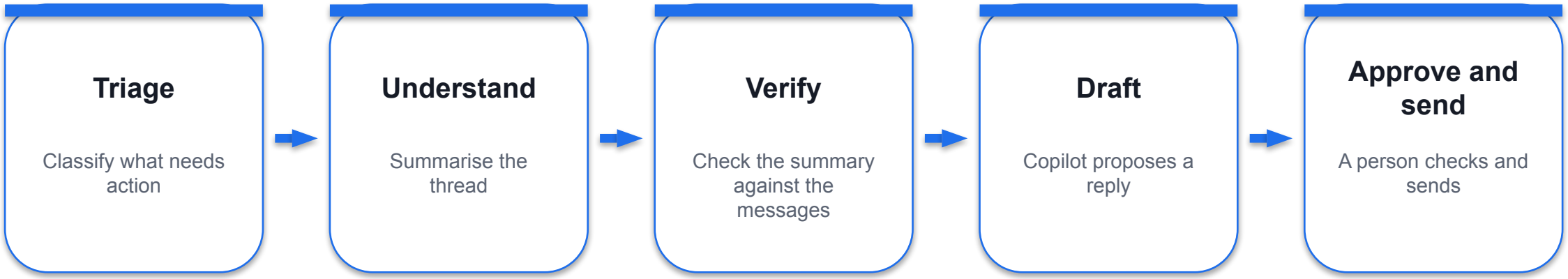
? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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TRIAGE TO SEND

The Outlook Communication Workflow



WHY IT MATTERS The send button is the control. Copilot never presses it.

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READING A LONG THREAD

What a Thread Summary Must Separate

1. **Decisions made**
   What was actually agreed, and by whom.

2. **Open questions**
   What is still unresolved.

3. **Actions and owners**
   Who committed to what, and by when.

4. **Contradictions**
   Where two messages disagree — surface it, do not resolve it.

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VERIFY BEFORE YOU ACT

A plausible summary is not a correct summary.

The check is not whether it reads well. It is whether each stated decision appears in the thread.

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BEFORE ANYTHING LEAVES

The Human-Send Gate

1

Recipients

Check the To and Cc lines — especially on a reply-all.

2

Facts

Every claim in the reply is one you can support.

3

Attachments

The right file, and only the right file.

4

Tone

Appropriate for the actual relationship, not the average one.

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Tea Break

10 minutes

CLEAN FIRST

Common Data Problems Copilot Cannot Fix

1

Merged cells

They break the one-record-per-row rule that analysis depends on.

2

Mixed types

Text like 'n/a' in a number column silently breaks aggregation.

3

Repeated headers

A header in the middle of the data becomes a phantom record.

4

Hidden totals

A total row inside the data gets counted as another record.

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FOUR QUESTION TYPES

Descriptive, Diagnostic, Predictive, Prescriptive

Type	The question	What it needs
Descriptive	What happened?	Clean, complete data
Diagnostic	Why did it happen?	Segmentation and comparison
Predictive	What is likely next?	History plus stated assumptions
Prescriptive	What should we do?	All of the above plus a decision rule

RULE Each level depends on the one before it being sound.

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EXCEL TABLES

Structured References and Why They Matter

1

They name the column

A formula reads as a sentence, not a grid coordinate.

2

They survive edits

Inserting a row does not silently break the range.

3

They auto-fill

A new record inherits the derived columns.

4

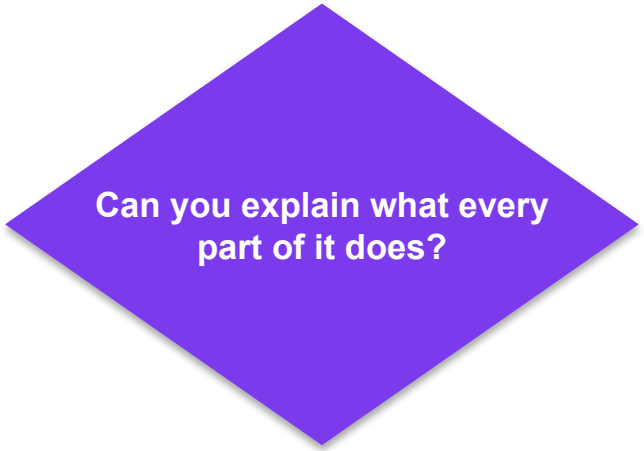
Copilot reads them better

A named table is unambiguous; a loose range is not.

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DECISION RULE

Should I Accept This Suggested Formula?



YES

- Accept it, and record it in the formula audit
- Test the zero, blank and negative cases first

NO

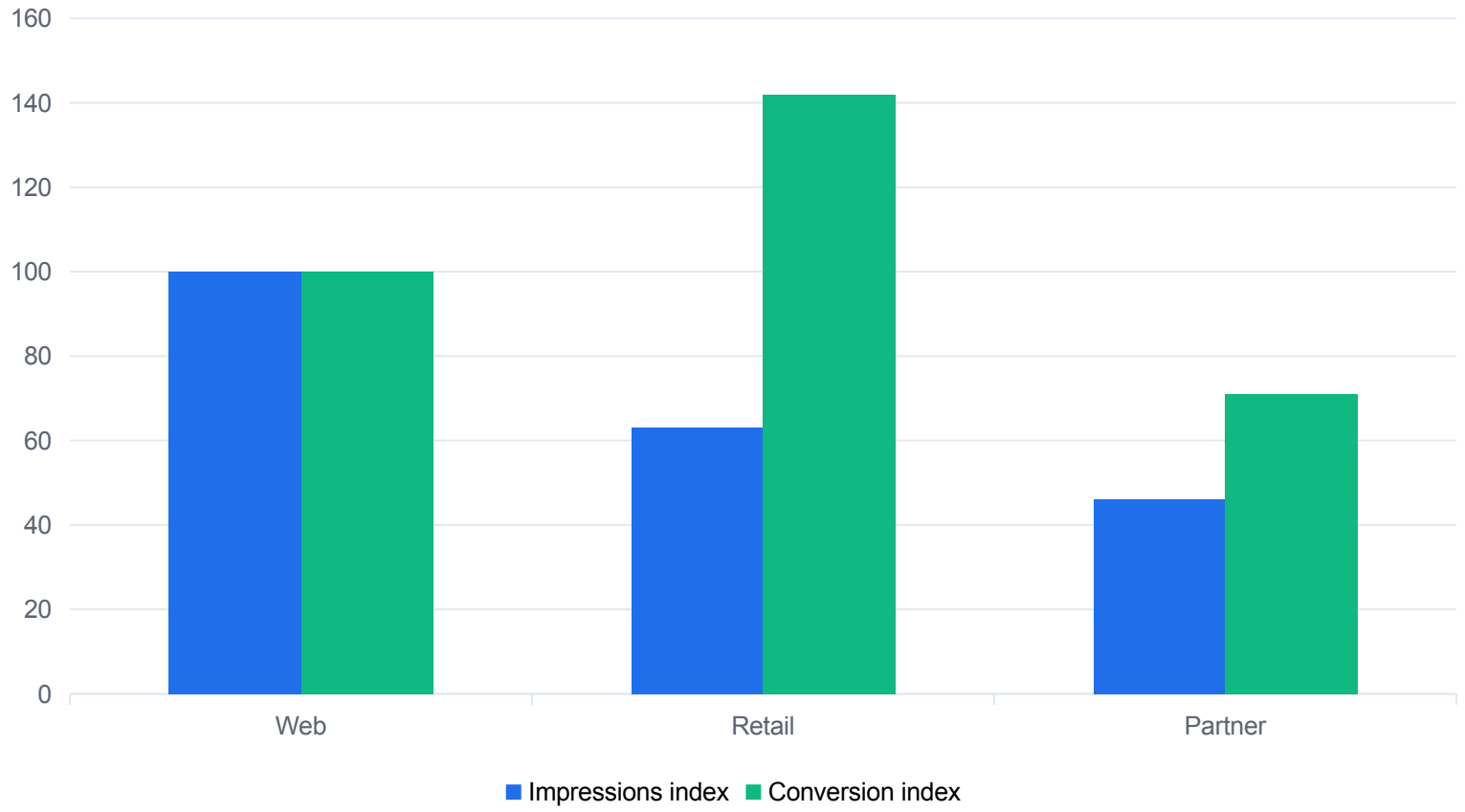
- Do not accept it yet
- Ask Copilot to explain it, then re-read it yourself

RULE A formula you cannot explain is a formula you cannot defend in a review.

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NATIVE CHART

Conversion Varies More Than Traffic



DECISION LENS

Retail draws fewer people and converts more of them. Averaging the channels hides both facts.

? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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What a Good Finding Contains

1. **The observation**
   What the data actually shows, stated plainly.

2. **The evidence**
   The sheet and cell range it came from.

3. **The caveat**
   What could make this conclusion wrong.

4. **The action**
   What should now happen, and who owns it.

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MODELLING DISCIPLINE

Separate the assumption from the formula.

If a scenario needs you to edit a formula, you have built a spreadsheet, not a model.

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WHAT IT DOES WELL

Outlook Copilot in Practice

1

Summarise a long thread

Turn forty messages into decisions and open questions.

2

Draft a reply

Propose a response in a tone and length you specify.

3

Coach a draft

Critique your own writing before you send it.

4

Catch up

Find what changed while you were away.

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TOPIC 02 · FOUNDATION

Build and Audit Excel Formulas with Copilot

LAB 06 K2 · A2

The learner converts a flat range into an Excel Table, asks Copilot to add derived margin, conversion and status columns, then audits each generated formula against the assumptions sheet.

You will build

A formula-driven campaign table with revenue, margin, conversion, status and error controls

Apps: Excel, Copilot

ASSESSED K2 · A2

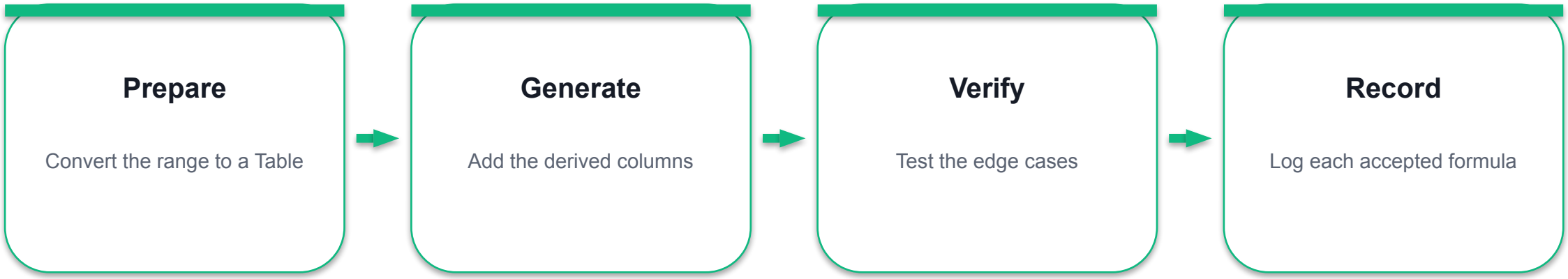
LEVEL Foundation

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 06 · PROCESS

How Lab 06 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 06) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 06 · ACCEPTANCE

Build and Audit Excel Formulas with Copilot

✅ Acceptance check

Every derived column uses a checked structured-reference formula, no error values remain, and the Controls sheet matches the expected record count and zero exceptions.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 02 · INTERMEDIATE

Run Deep Descriptive and Diagnostic Analysis in Excel

LAB 07 K2 · A2

The learner uses Copilot to summarise performance, segment it by region, channel and product, isolate anomalies, and write management findings that each cite the cells they came from.

You will build

A diagnostic workbook with a KPI summary, segment analysis, an anomaly log and management findings

Apps: Excel, Copilot

ASSESSED K2 · A2

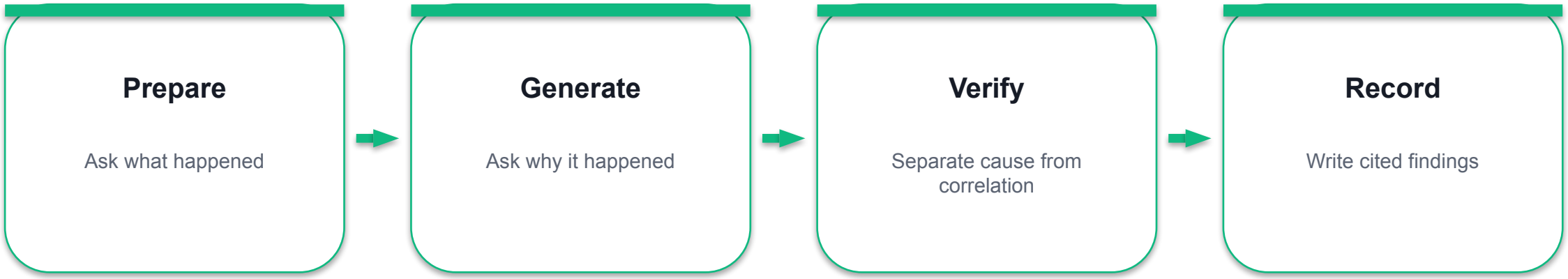
LEVEL Intermediate

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LAB 07 · PROCESS

How Lab 07 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 07) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 07 · ACCEPTANCE

Run Deep Descriptive and Diagnostic Analysis in Excel

✅ Acceptance check

The workbook holds a KPI summary, a segment breakdown, a populated anomaly log, and findings that each cite the sheet and range supporting them.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 02 · ADVANCED

Forecast and Stress-Test a Campaign with Copilot

LAB 08 K2 · A2

The learner builds base, downside and upside forecasts from the historical data, runs a sensitivity table across the key drivers, and records the guardrails that say when the forecast should not be trusted.

You will build

A forecast model with base, downside and upside scenarios, a sensitivity table and decision guardrails

Apps: Excel, Copilot

ASSESSED K2 · A2

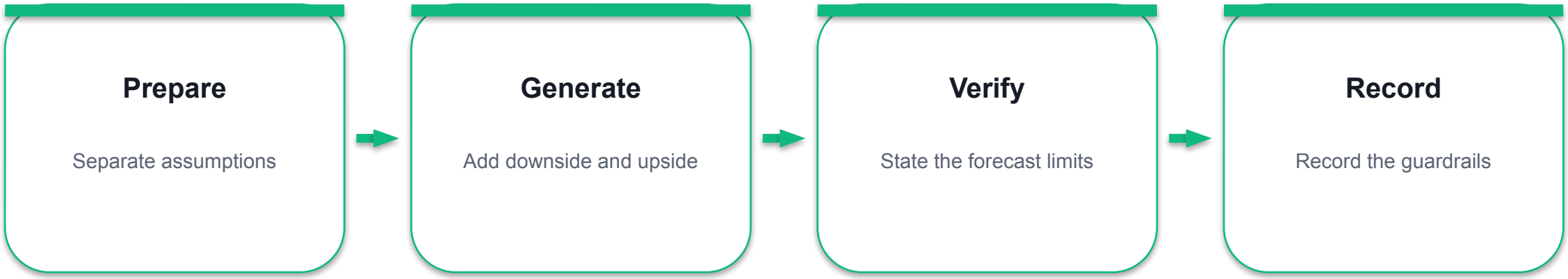
LEVEL Advanced

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 08 · PROCESS

How Lab 08 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 08) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 08 · ACCEPTANCE

Forecast and Stress-Test a Campaign with Copilot

✅ Acceptance check

Changing a single assumption cell updates all three scenarios and the sensitivity table, and the workbook states the conditions under which the forecast does not hold.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 02 · INTERMEDIATE

Triage an Outlook Inbox and Draft a Controlled Reply

LAB 09 K2 · A2

The learner triages a supplied mail pack, summarises a long thread, verifies the summary against the original messages, and drafts one reply that is explicitly approved before it would be sent.

You will build

An inbox triage register, a verified thread summary and one approval-ready draft reply

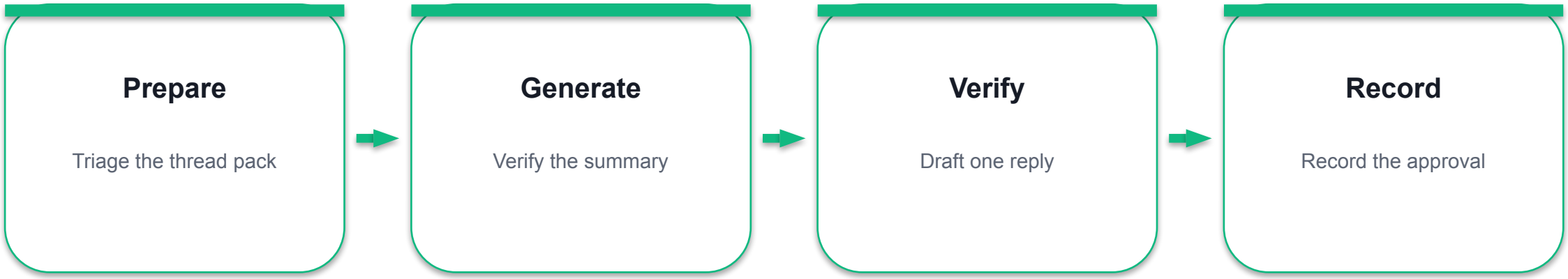
Apps: Outlook, Excel, Copilot

ASSESSED	LEVEL	EVIDENCE
K2 · A2	Intermediate	Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 09 · PROCESS

How Lab 09 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 09) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 09 · ACCEPTANCE

Triage an Outlook Inbox and Draft a Controlled Reply

✅ Acceptance check

The triage register classifies every message, the thread summary matches the original messages, and the draft reply carries a named approver before any send.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 02 · INTERMEDIATE

Turn Meeting Notes into an Action Register

LAB 10 K2 · A2

The learner turns a supplied meeting-notes document into a decision log and an action register with named owners and due dates, then verifies every action against the source notes.

You will build

A meeting brief, a decision log, an action register and a reviewed follow-up message

Apps: Teams, Word, Excel, Copilot

ASSESSED K2 · A2

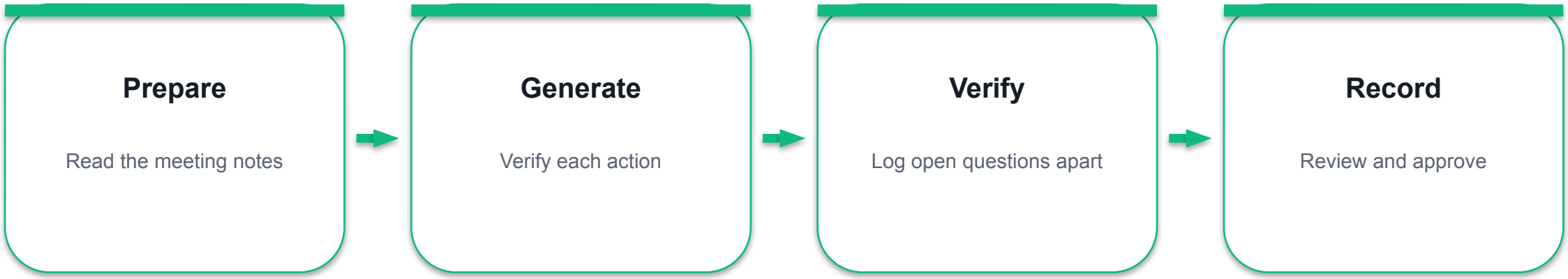
LEVEL Intermediate

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 10 · PROCESS

How Lab 10 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 10) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 10 · ACCEPTANCE

Turn Meeting Notes into an Action Register

✅ Acceptance check

Every action in the register cites a supporting line from the notes and carries a named owner and due date, and unresolved questions are listed separately from actions.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

Recap — Topic 02

1

Lab 06

Generate derived columns with Copilot and audit every formula before accepting it

2

Lab 07

Move from what happened to why it happened, with each finding traced to evidence

3

Lab 08

Build a scenario model that separates assumptions from formulas and states its own limits

4

Lab 09

Use Copilot to triage and summarise mail, then draft a reply that a person approves before sending

5

Lab 10

Convert an unstructured meeting record into owned, dated and verifiable actions

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End of Day 2

See you tomorrow

03

TOPIC 03

Business Process Automation with Power Automate

BPA · the Power Platform · triggers · actions · dynamic content · conditions · approvals

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DAY 3 · WHAT THIS TOPIC COVERS

Key Concepts — Topic 03

1. Business process automation replaces repeated manual handovers with a reliable, auditable flow.
2. Every flow is Trigger then Actions then Output: something happens, steps run, a result is produced.
3. The four trigger families are automated, instant, scheduled and business-process triggers.
4. Dynamic content passes data from one step to the next; the run history shows exactly what each step received.
5. A condition branches a flow so different inputs follow different paths.
6. An approval action suspends the run until a named person responds, which is human-in-the-loop by design.

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WHAT YOU WILL DO

Hands-On Labs — Topic 03

Labs 11–12

- Prepare the Power Platform Environment
- Build a Trigger and Actions Flow from Microsoft Forms

Labs 13–14

- Log Form Submissions to Excel Online
- Branch a Flow with a Condition

Labs 15–15

- Suspend a Flow for a Human Approval

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THE HAND-OFF

What Automation Actually Removes

1

The re-typing

Someone copying what another system already knows.

2

The delay

Work waiting for a person to notice it.

3

The forgotten step

The reply nobody remembered to send.

4

The missing record

No trace of what happened, or when.

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WHY AUTOMATE

Manual Process vs Automated Flow

	Manual	Automated
Steps	Form read, re-typed, reply remembered	Form submitted, row written, reply sent
Consistency	Depends who is on duty	The same every time, including at 3am
Record	Whatever someone wrote down	A run history anyone can read later
People spend time on	Copying	The judgement the machine cannot make

RULE Automate what is repetitive, rule-based and time-consuming.

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THE PIECES

The Power Platform

1

Power Automate

Workflows — triggers and actions that run without a person.

2

Copilot Studio

Conversational agents with instructions, knowledge and tools.

3

Dataverse

The managed data store behind the environment.

4

Connectors

Outlook, Excel, SharePoint, Teams, Forms, HTTP — over a thousand.

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START HERE

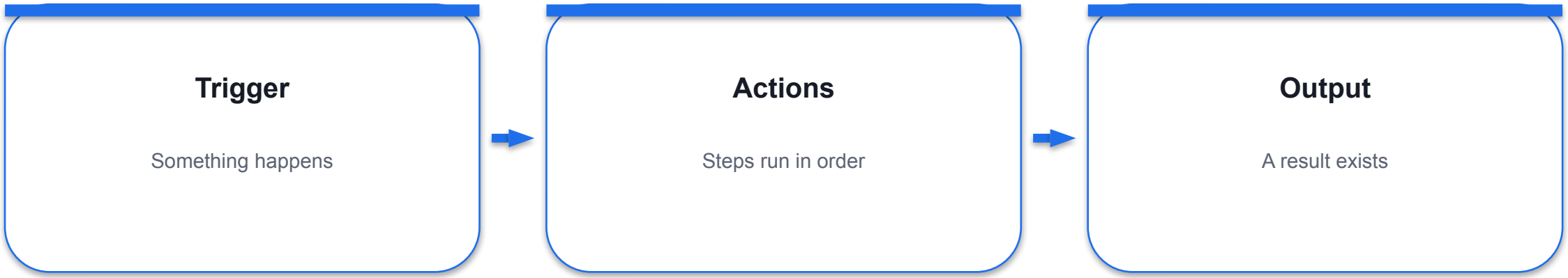
The environment matters more than any single tool.

A flow built in the wrong environment is a flow nobody else can find, run or govern.

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FLOW ANATOMY

Every Flow Is the Same Three Things



WHY IT MATTERS If you can name the trigger, the actions and the output, you can build the flow.

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WHAT STARTS A FLOW

The Four Trigger Families

1

Automated

An event occurs — a form is submitted, a file arrives, mail is received.

2

Instant

A person presses a button, in an app or on a phone.

3

Scheduled

A clock fires — every hour, every weekday, every month-end.

4

Business process

A stage in a modelled process is reached.

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WHAT A FLOW CAN DO

The Six Action Families

1

Create

Add a record, a row, a file or an item.

2

Read

Get an item, a row, a response or a file's content.

3

Update

Change something that already exists.

4

Delete

Remove a record — the one to be most careful with.

5

Notify

Send mail, post to Teams, raise an approval.

6

Control

Condition, loop, scope, delay, terminate.

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DECISION RULE

Should I Type This Value or Insert It?



YES

- Insert it from the dynamic content panel
- The token carries the real value at run time

NO

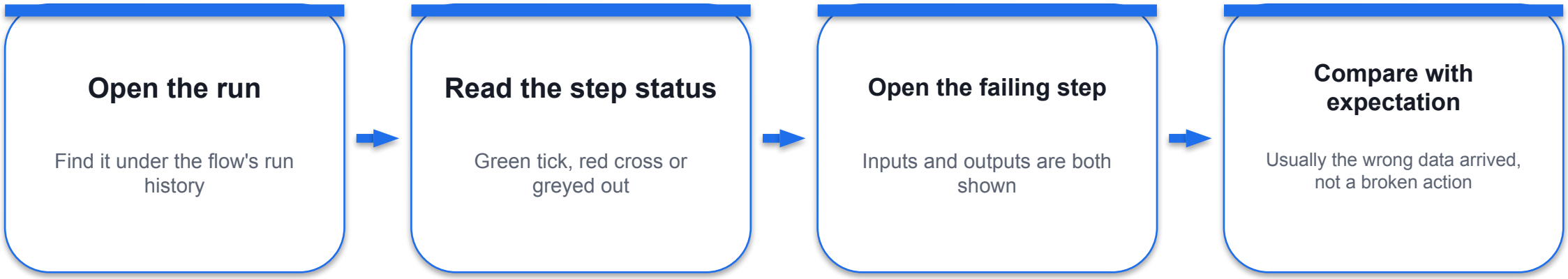
- Type it as a literal
- Only for genuinely fixed text

RULE A dynamic value that is typed as words is the single most common reason a flow 'runs but does nothing'.

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DIAGNOSIS

Reading a Run History



WHY IT MATTERS Three states look similar and mean different things: succeeded, failed, and skipped.

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READ CAREFULLY

Three Run States That Look Alike

State	What it means	What to do
Succeeded	The step ran and completed	Check the output is what you expected
Failed	The step ran and errored	Read the error and the step inputs
Skipped	The step never ran	Check the branch condition above it

RULE A skipped action in an untaken branch is correct behaviour, not a bug.

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ROUTING WORK

Conditions and Branching

1

A condition is a test

It evaluates to true or false, nothing else.

2

Two branches

If yes and If no; both need building and testing.

3

Test both paths

A branch that never ran is a branch you have not tested.

4

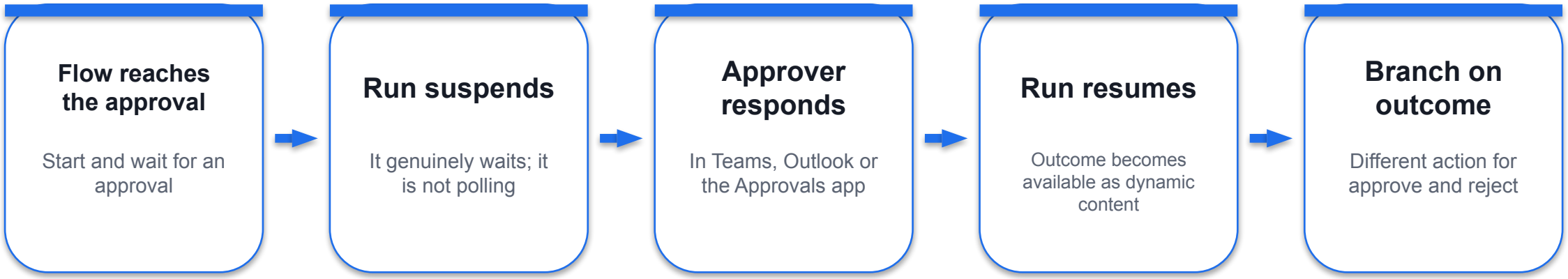
Keep it shallow

Deeply nested conditions become unmaintainable quickly.

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HUMAN IN THE LOOP

How an Approval Suspends a Run



WHY IT MATTERS The run can wait for days. That is the feature, not a timeout to work around.

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LEVELS OF CONTROL

Human In, On, or Out of the Loop

1

In the loop

A person must act before the process continues.

2

On the loop

The process runs; a person monitors and can intervene.

3

Out of the loop

Fully automatic, with no person involved.

4

Choose by consequence

The more expensive the mistake, the more you want a person in.

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Tea Break

10 minutes

FEASIBILITY SCAN

Spotting an Automation Candidate

1

Repetitive

The same steps happen many times a week.

2

Rule-based

The decision can be written down as a rule.

3

Time-consuming

Enough volume that the saving is real.

4

Digital already

The data is already in a system, not on paper.

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DECISION RULE

Automate This Process, or Fix It First?



YES

- Automate it — the rules are known
- Document the rules before you build

NO

- Fix the process first
- Automating a broken process makes it fail faster

RULE Automation amplifies a process. It does not improve one.

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OVER A THOUSAND

Connectors Are the Integration Layer

1

Microsoft 365

Outlook, Excel, SharePoint, Teams, Forms, OneDrive.

2

Business systems

Dataverse, Dynamics, SQL, Salesforce, SAP.

3

Generic

HTTP, webhooks and custom connectors for anything else.

4

Each has actions and triggers

What it can start, and what it can do.

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WHICH ONE DO I NEED?

Trigger Families in Practice

If you want...	Use	Example
A reaction to an event	Automated	A form is submitted
A person to start it	Instant	A button in the mobile app
It to run on a clock	Scheduled	A month-end report
A stage to drive it	Business process	An opportunity reaches Proposal

RULE Choose the trigger by what should start the work, not by what is convenient.

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INSERT, DO NOT TYPE

Dynamic Content: The Number One Mistake

1

What it is

A token carrying a real value from an earlier step.

2

What it looks like

A coloured chip in the field, not plain words.

3

The failure

Typing the field name sends the literal words at run time.

4

The symptom

The flow succeeds and the output is wrong.

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READ THE OUTPUTS

A green run does not mean a correct run.

Every step succeeded. That tells you nothing about whether the right data moved.

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THINK FIRST

Designing a Flow Before Building It

1. **Name the trigger**
   What single event starts this?

2. **List the actions**
   In order, with the data each one needs.

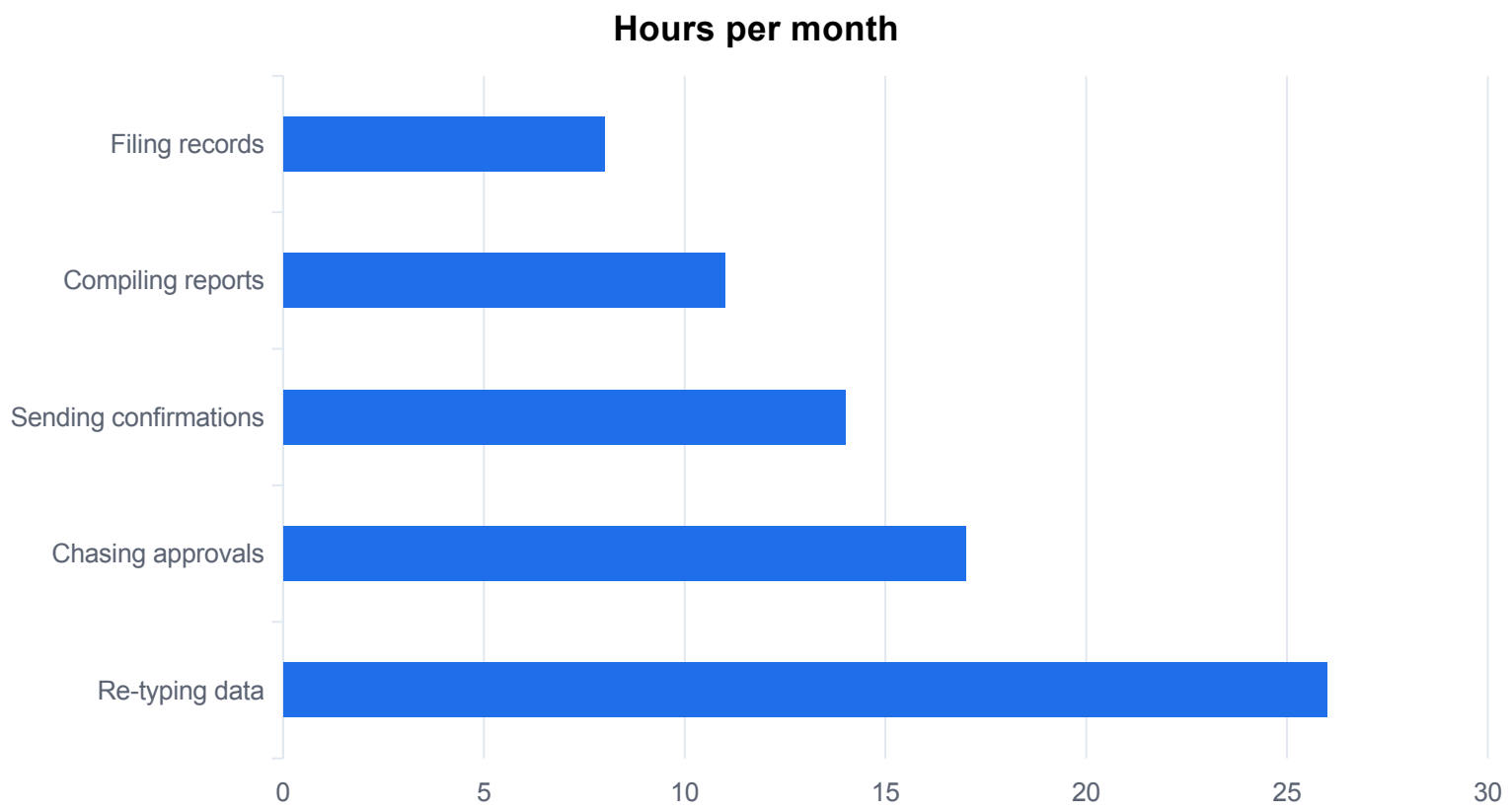
3. **Find the decisions**
   Anywhere the path could differ.

4. **Decide the failure behaviour**
   What should happen when a step errors?

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NATIVE CHART

Where Manual Effort Concentrates



DECISION LENS

Re-typing dominates — and it is the easiest thing on this chart to remove.

? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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TOPIC 03 · FOUNDATION

Prepare the Power Platform Environment

LAB 11 | K3 · A1

The learner selects the correct Power Platform environment, confirms the connectors and connections the course needs, and records the environment details that every later lab depends on.

You will build

A verified working environment with the Forms, Outlook, Excel, Approvals and SharePoint connections in place

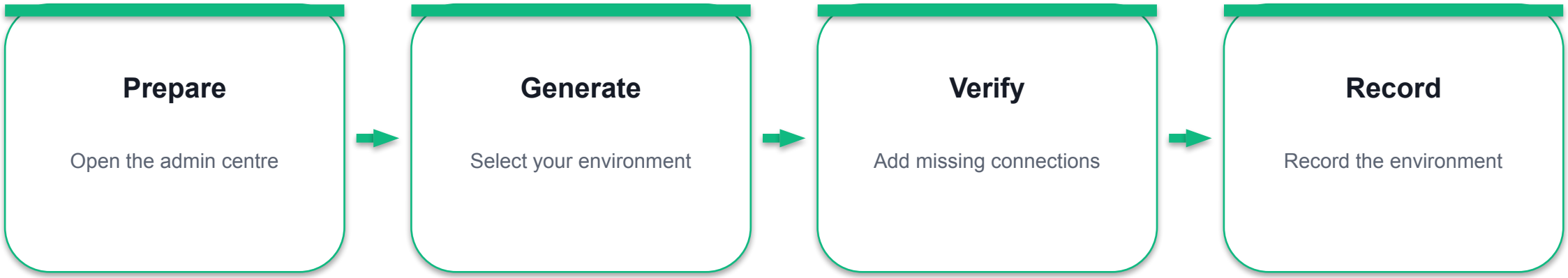
Apps: Power Platform admin centre, Power Automate

ASSESSED	LEVEL	EVIDENCE
K3 · A1	Foundation	Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 11 · PROCESS

How Lab 11 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 11) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 11 · ACCEPTANCE

Prepare the Power Platform Environment

✅ Acceptance check

The environment selector shows the recorded environment, and every connector needed by the course appears under Connections with a working status.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 03 · FOUNDATION

Build a Trigger and Actions Flow from Microsoft Forms

LAB 12 K3 · A3

The learner creates a Microsoft Form, builds an automated cloud flow that starts on submission, retrieves the answers and sends a personalised confirmation to the address the requester entered.

You will build

A working Forms-to-email flow that acknowledges every enquiry automatically

Apps: Power Automate, Microsoft Forms, Outlook

ASSESSED K3 · A3

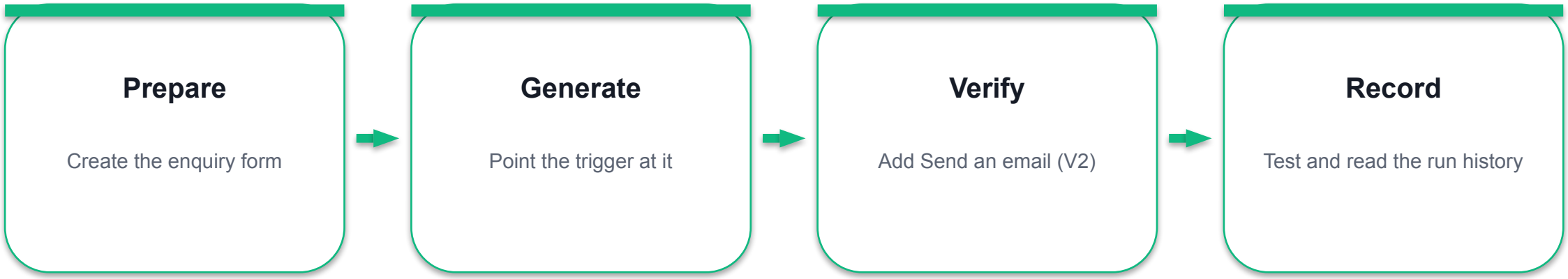
LEVEL Foundation

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 12 · PROCESS

How Lab 12 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 12) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 12 · ACCEPTANCE

Build a Trigger and Actions Flow from Microsoft Forms

✅ Acceptance check

One form submission produces one successful run, and the confirmation email arrives at the address entered in the form rather than the flow owner's mailbox.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 03 · INTERMEDIATE

Log Form Submissions to Excel Online

LAB 13 K3 · A3

The learner extends the enquiry flow so each submission also writes a row into a named Excel table, producing an auditable log alongside the email acknowledgement.

You will build

An enquiry flow that both emails the requester and appends a row to an Excel log table

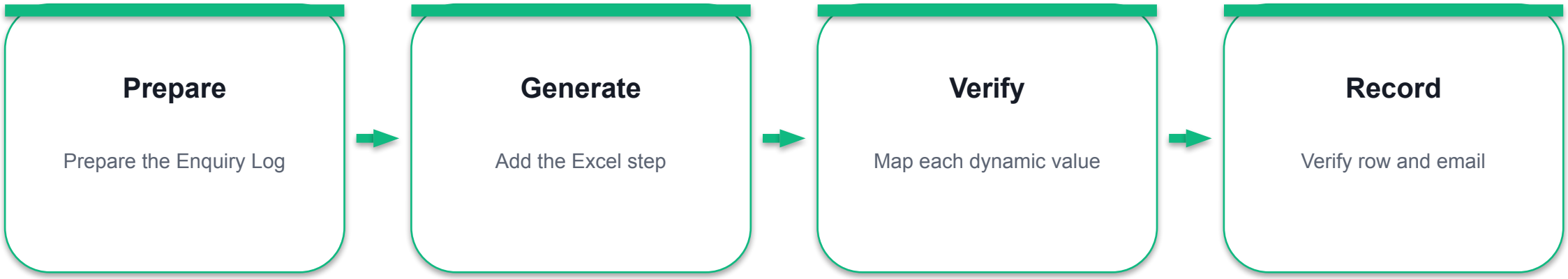
Apps: Power Automate, Microsoft Forms, Excel Online, OneDrive

ASSESSED	LEVEL	EVIDENCE
K3 · A3	Intermediate	Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 13 · PROCESS

How Lab 13 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 13) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 13 · ACCEPTANCE

Log Form Submissions to Excel Online

✅ Acceptance check

A single form submission produces one new row in the EnquiryLog table with all five columns populated, and one confirmation email.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 03 · INTERMEDIATE

Branch a Flow with a Condition

LAB 14 K3 · A3

The learner adds a condition so that enquiries are handled differently according to their content, sending an urgent notification down one branch and a standard acknowledgement down the other.

You will build

A branching flow whose two paths are both proven by a test submission

Apps: Power Automate, Microsoft Forms, Outlook

ASSESSED K3 · A3

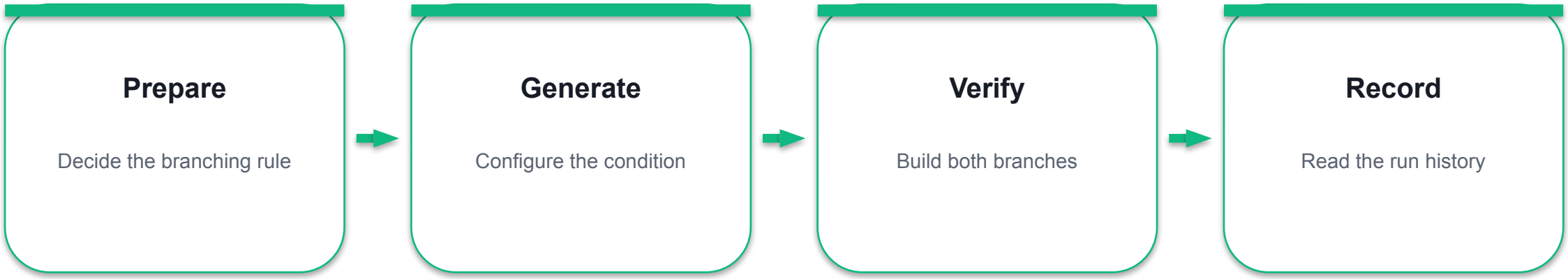
LEVEL Intermediate

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 14 · PROCESS

How Lab 14 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 14) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 14 · ACCEPTANCE

Branch a Flow with a Condition

✅ Acceptance check

Two submissions produce two successful runs that each take a different branch, and the run history shows the untaken branch as skipped rather than failed.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 03 · ADVANCED

Suspend a Flow for a Human Approval

LAB 15 K5 · A7

The learner builds a leave-application flow that pauses at an approval action, waits for a named approver's decision, and then takes a different action for an approved and a rejected outcome.

You will build

A leave-application flow that suspends until an approver responds and records the outcome

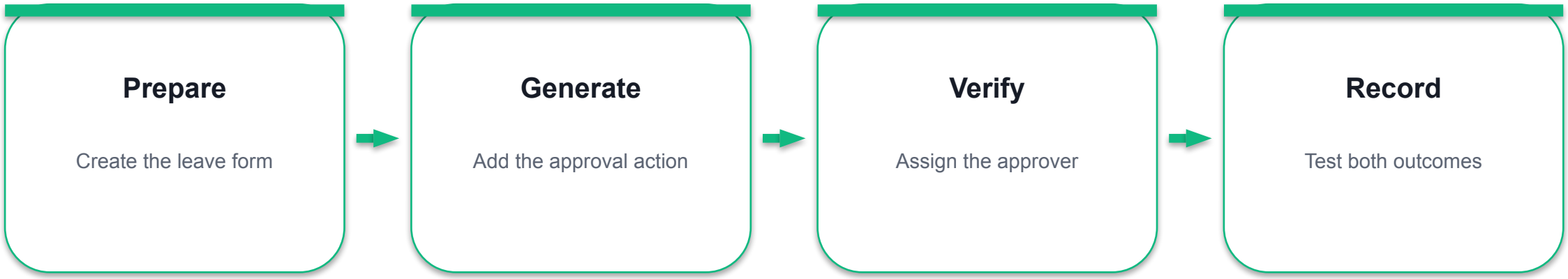
Apps: Power Automate, Approvals, Outlook, Teams

ASSESSED	LEVEL	EVIDENCE
K5 · A7	Advanced	Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 15 · PROCESS

How Lab 15 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 15) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 15 · ACCEPTANCE

Suspend a Flow for a Human Approval

✅ Acceptance check

The run remains in a waiting state until the approver responds, then resumes down the branch matching the decision and emails the applicant the correct outcome.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

Recap — Topic 03

1

Lab 11

Identify the environment that holds your automation and confirm the connections it needs

2

Lab 12

Build an automated cloud flow that reacts to an event and sends a personalised response

3

Lab 13

Integrate a flow with a second system so every submission is recorded as a row of data

4

Lab 14

Route a process down different paths according to the data it receives

5

Lab 15

Insert a human decision into an automated process so a consequential action needs a person

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End of Day 3

See you tomorrow

04

TOPIC 04

Designing and Building Copilot Studio Agents

Workflow vs agent · instructions · knowledge · tools · skills · connected agents · publishing

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Key Concepts — Topic 04

1. A workflow follows a fixed path; an agent decides which step to take next from its instructions.
2. An agent is made of instructions, knowledge, tools, skills and connected agents.
3. Instructions shape behaviour but are not enforced; tools, schemas and approvals are what actually enforce limits.
4. Grounding an agent in approved knowledge is what makes its answers citable and its refusals correct.
5. A tool lets an agent act on a system; a connected agent delegates a task to another specialised agent.
6. Publishing to a channel such as Microsoft Teams makes the agent available to real users.

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WHAT YOU WILL DO

Hands-On Labs — Topic 04

Labs 16–17

- Design a Scoped Agent Before You Build It
- Build and Ground a Copilot Studio Agent

Labs 18–19

- Give an Agent a Tool and a Knowledge Source
- Orchestrate Connected Agents

Labs 20–20

- Publish an Agent to Microsoft Teams

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THE CORE DISTINCTION

A Workflow and an Agent Are Not the Same Thing

	Workflow	Agent
Path	Fixed and defined in advance	Chosen at run time by the model
Input	Structured — a form, a row, an event	Natural language
Behaviour	Deterministic and repeatable	Variable within its instructions
Best for	Known, repeatable processes	Requests you cannot enumerate in advance

RULE If the path is always the same, build a flow. An agent is for when it is not.

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AGENT ANATOMY

What an Agent Is Made Of

1

Instructions

The role, the limits and the tone, written in prose.

2

Knowledge

The approved sources it may cite.

3

Tools

The actions it can take on real systems.

4

Skills

Instructions supplied on demand for a specific task.

5

Connected agents

Other agents it can delegate work to.

6

Channels

Where users actually meet it — Teams, a site, an app.

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THE MOST IMPORTANT SLIDE TODAY

Instructions are not enforcement.

The model can ignore an instruction. It cannot ignore a tool that does not exist or an approval it cannot grant itself.

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RANKING THE CONTROLS

What Actually Constrains an Agent

Control	Strength	Why
A tool the agent does not have	Strongest	It cannot call what does not exist
A required human approval	Strong	The action cannot complete alone
A schema or typed contract	Medium	Malformed data is rejected
An instruction in prose	Weakest	The model may not follow it

RULE A control the model cannot reach beats a rule you asked it to follow.

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THE INSTRUCTION CRAFT

Writing Instructions That Work

1

State the role

One sentence on who the agent is and who it serves.

2

State the sources

Which knowledge it may use, and that it must cite.

3

State the refusals

What is out of scope, explicitly.

4

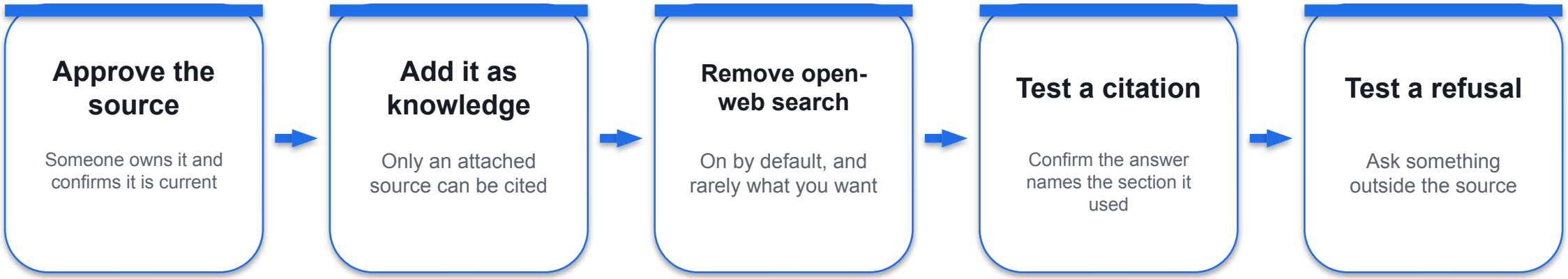
State the escalation

Who to point the user to when it cannot help.

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RETRIEVAL

Grounding an Agent in Knowledge



WHY IT MATTERS An agent grounded in nothing will still answer. That is the problem.

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DECISION RULE

Should the Agent Do This Alone?



YES

- Require a human approval before it takes effect
- Log the request either way

NO

- The agent may act, with an audit record
- Review the log periodically

RULE Draw the boundary of agency before you build, not after the first incident.

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FROM ANSWERING TO DOING

Tools: Letting an Agent Act

1

A tool is a published flow

The agent calls it; the flow does the work.

2

The description is the interface

It is how the model decides whether to call it.

3

Inputs and outputs are a contract

Ambiguous fields produce inconsistent behaviour.

4

Unpublished means unavailable

A flow that is not published cannot be attached.

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TOOL DESIGN

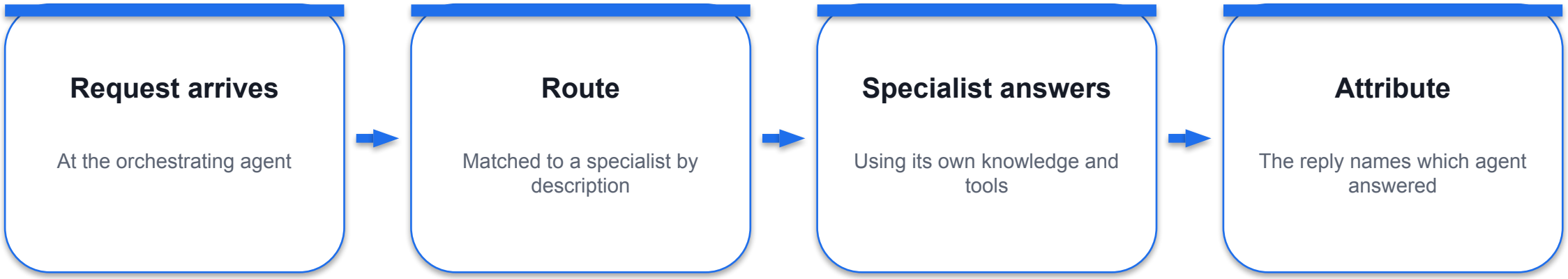
A vague tool description is a tool that is never called — or always called.

The description is not documentation. It is the instruction the model actually acts on.

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DELEGATION

Connected Agents and Orchestration



WHY IT MATTERS Overlapping specialist descriptions produce inconsistent routing. Make the boundaries explicit.

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THREE KINDS OF TEST

Testing an Agent Properly

1

It answers what it should

In-scope questions, with a correct citation.

2

It refuses what it should

Out-of-scope questions produce a refusal, not a guess.

3

It handles the edge cases

The plausible-but-wrong inputs that look fine.

4

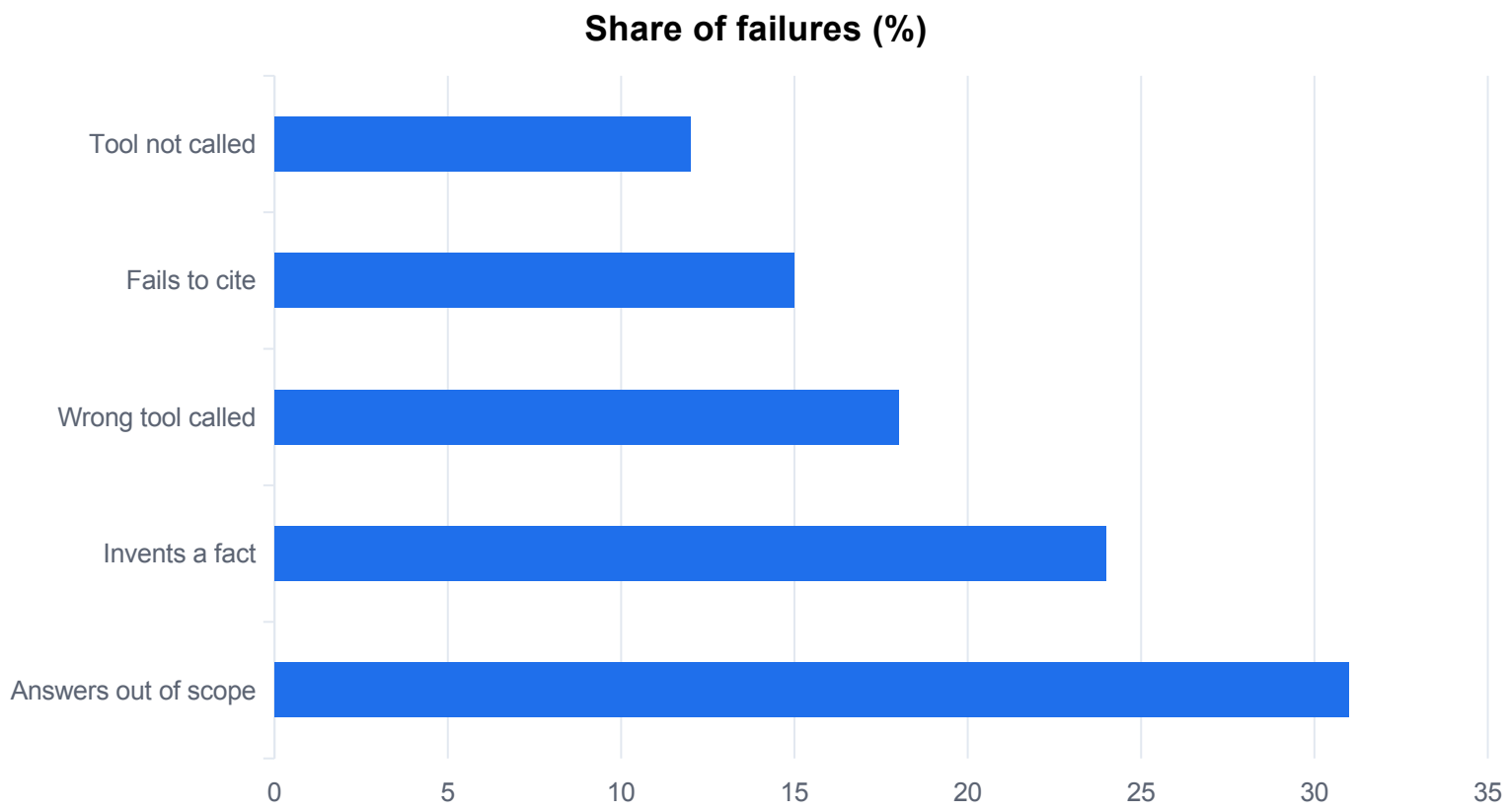
Every result is recorded

Expected versus actual, for each case.

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NATIVE CHART

Where Agents Fail in Testing



DECISION LENS

Most failures are scope and invention — which is exactly what refusal tests catch.

? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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GOING LIVE

Publishing and Channels

1

Users get the published version

Not your latest unpublished edit.

2

Test in the channel

The test pane is not where users meet the agent.

3

Re-test refusals after publishing

A refusal that only works in test is a defect.

4

Have a rollback plan

A release without one is not a controlled release.

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Tea Break

10 minutes

BE HONEST

When an Agent Is the Wrong Answer

1. **The path never varies**
   A flow is cheaper, faster and testable.

2. **The answer must be exact**
   A deterministic lookup beats a generated one.

3. **There is no approved source**
   An ungrounded agent will still answer.

4. **Nobody will own it**
   An unmaintained agent decays into a liability.

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WHAT EACH ONE IS FOR

Instructions, Knowledge, Tools and Skills

Element	Purpose	Enforced?
Instructions	Role, tone, scope and refusals	No — guidance only
Knowledge	The sources it may cite	Partly — it can only cite what is attached
Tools	Actions it can take on systems	Yes — it cannot call what it lacks
Skills	Task instructions supplied on demand	No — guidance, delivered contextually

RULE Only tools and gates are enforcement. Everything else is persuasion.

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THE TRAP

Why 'Search All Websites' Is On By Default

1

It is convenient

The agent can always answer something.

2

It is ungrounded

The answer no longer comes from your approved source.

3

It looks like success

A fluent wrong answer passes a casual test.

4

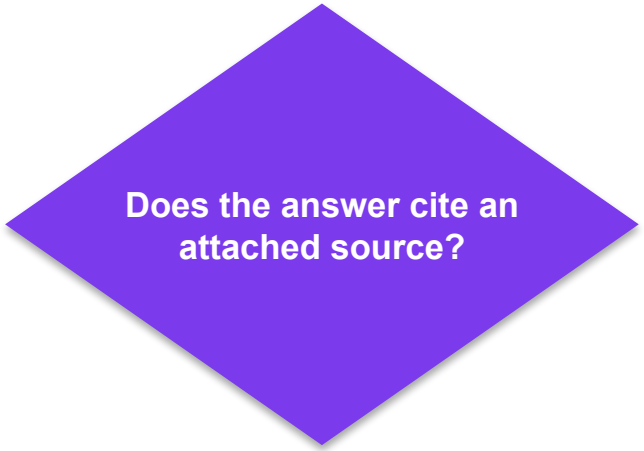
Remove it before testing

Otherwise your refusal tests will all falsely pass.

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DECISION RULE

Did the Agent Answer, or Did It Guess?



YES

- Verify the citation actually says that
- A citation can be present and wrong

NO

- Treat it as a guess
- Fix the grounding, not the wording of the question

RULE Requiring a citation is what converts an invisible failure into a visible one.

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THE MINIMUM SET

Test Cases Every Agent Needs

1. **A clear in-scope question**
   It should answer, and cite.

2. **A clear out-of-scope question**
   It should refuse, and redirect.

3. **A borderline question**
   Reveals where the boundary actually sits.

4. **A leading question**
   One that presumes a false fact; it should not agree.

5. **A near-miss name**
   A wrong-case or misspelled entity; behaviour must stay correct.

6. **A repeat**
   The same question twice; answers should not contradict.

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EDGE CASES

Test the cases that are cheap to get wrong and expensive to miss.

The suspended vendor at $900 is the case that passes review and costs you later.

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GOVERNANCE

Publishing Is a Release, Not a Save

1

Version

Users get the published version, not your draft.

2

Tests

The acceptance set is the release gate.

3

Approver

A named person authorises the release.

4

Rollback

Decided before release, not during an incident.

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TOPIC 04 · FOUNDATION

Design a Scoped Agent Before You Build It

LAB 16 K4 · A1

The learner produces an agent design canvas that states the job the agent does, what it must refuse, the knowledge it may use, the actions it may take and the tests that will prove it behaves.

You will build

An agent design canvas, a knowledge register, a risk-and-control table and ten acceptance tests

Apps: Copilot Studio, Excel

ASSESSED K4 · A1

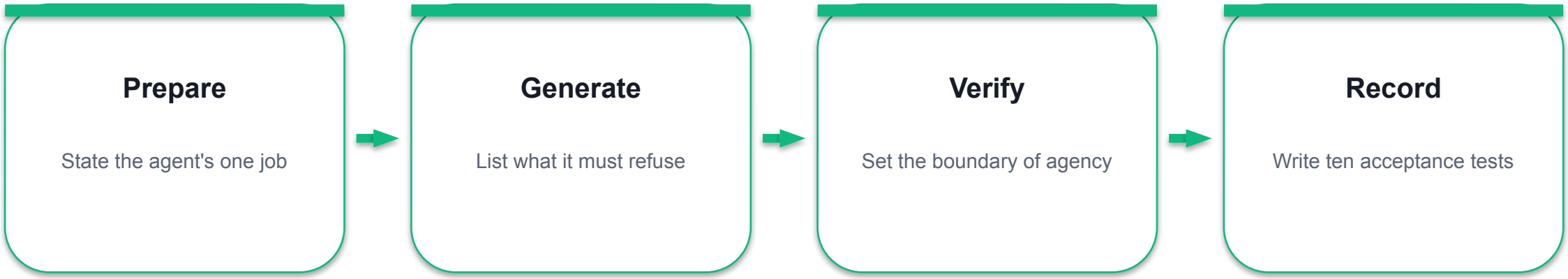
LEVEL Foundation

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 16 · PROCESS

How Lab 16 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 16) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 16 · ACCEPTANCE

Design a Scoped Agent Before You Build It

✅ Acceptance check

The canvas states one job, lists explicit refusals, registers every knowledge source with an owner, and carries ten acceptance tests of which at least three expect a refusal.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 04 · INTERMEDIATE

Build and Ground a Copilot Studio Agent

LAB 17 K4 · A5

The learner creates an agent in Copilot Studio, writes instructions that define its role and limits, attaches the approved policy as knowledge, removes the open-web source and tests that it cites and refuses correctly.

You will build

A working, grounded agent that answers from the approved policy and refuses everything else

Apps: Copilot Studio, SharePoint

ASSESSED K4 · A5

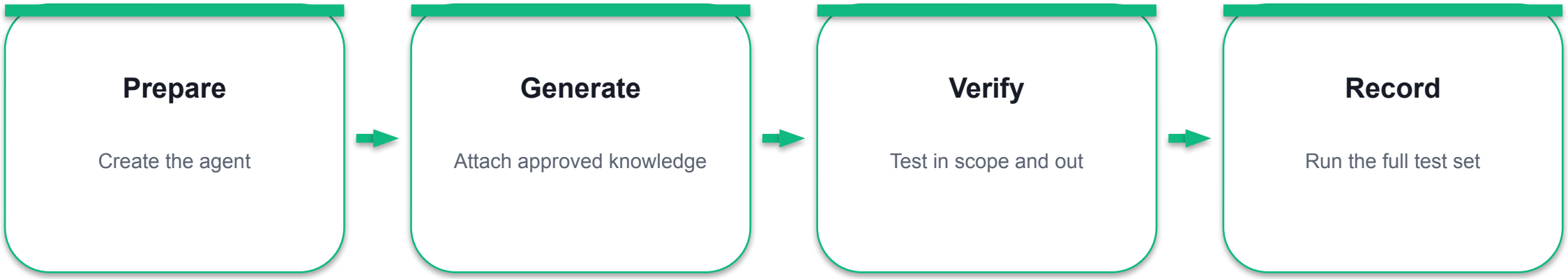
LEVEL Intermediate

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 17 · PROCESS

How Lab 17 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 17) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 17 · ACCEPTANCE

Build and Ground a Copilot Studio Agent

✅ Acceptance check

The agent cites the policy for in-scope questions, refuses and redirects for out-of-scope ones, and passes every acceptance test recorded in the workbook.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 04 · INTERMEDIATE

Give an Agent a Tool and a Knowledge Source

LAB 18 K4 · A5

The learner creates a SharePoint list of approved vendors, publishes an agent flow that looks a vendor up, attaches it to the agent as a tool, and proves the agent calls it instead of guessing.

You will build

An agent that answers vendor questions from a live SharePoint list through a published tool

Apps: Copilot Studio, SharePoint, Power Automate

ASSESSED K4 · A5

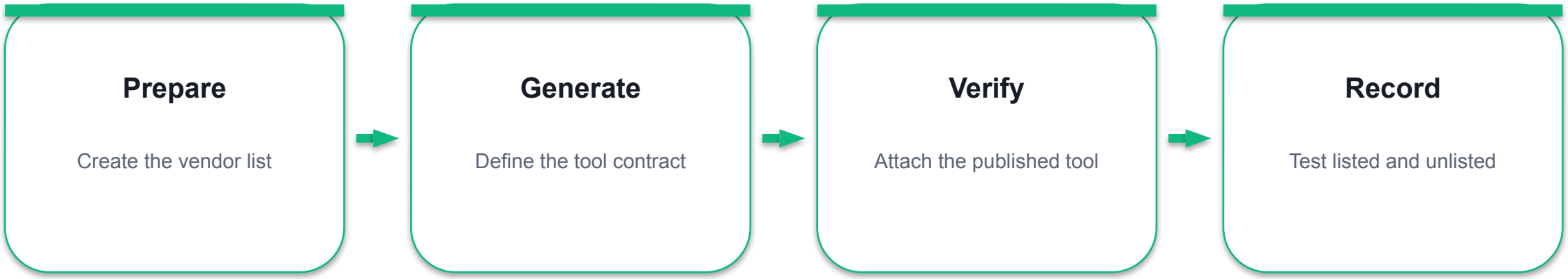
LEVEL Intermediate

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 18 · PROCESS

How Lab 18 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 18) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 18 · ACCEPTANCE

Give an Agent a Tool and a Knowledge Source

✅ Acceptance check

The agent returns the correct live status for a listed vendor and reports an unlisted vendor as not approved, with the run history showing the tool was actually called.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 04 · ADVANCED

Orchestrate Connected Agents

LAB 19 K4 · A5

The learner builds a second specialised agent and connects it to the first, so an orchestrating agent routes each request to the right specialist and reports which one answered.

You will build

An orchestrating agent that routes requests to a connected specialist agent

Apps: Copilot Studio, connected agents

ASSESSED K4 · A5

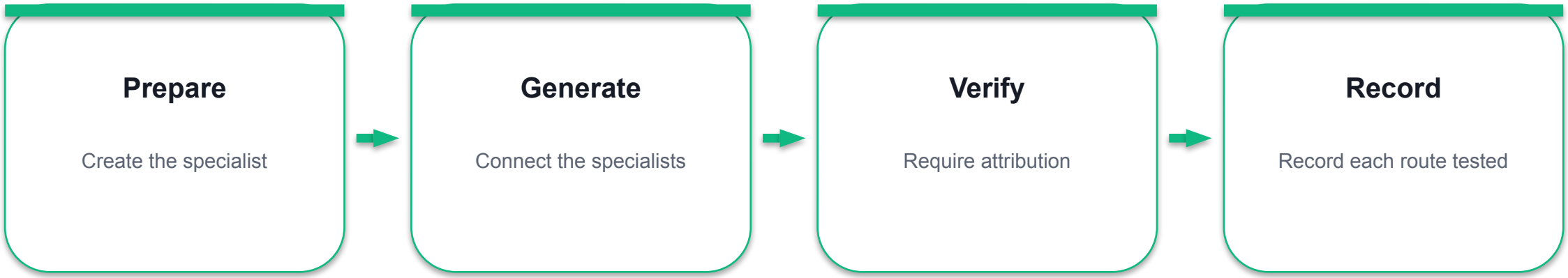
LEVEL Advanced

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 19 · PROCESS

How Lab 19 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 19) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 19 · ACCEPTANCE

Orchestrate Connected Agents

✅ Acceptance check

Each test request reaches the correct specialist, the out-of-scope request is refused, and every reply names the agent that answered it.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 04 · ADVANCED

Publish an Agent to Microsoft Teams

LAB 20 K4 · A5

The learner publishes the grounded agent to Microsoft Teams, confirms the published version behaves as the test version did, and records the release decision and rollback plan.

You will build

A published agent available in Microsoft Teams with a recorded release decision

Apps: Copilot Studio, Microsoft Teams

ASSESSED K4 · A5

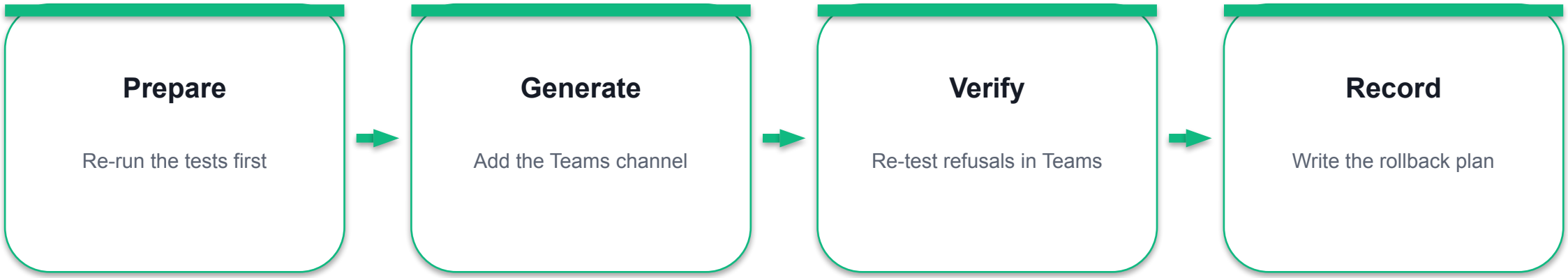
LEVEL Advanced

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 20 · PROCESS

How Lab 20 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 20) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 20 · ACCEPTANCE

Publish an Agent to Microsoft Teams

✅ Acceptance check

The agent responds correctly inside Microsoft Teams, still refuses out-of-scope questions, and the release log records the version, tests, approver and rollback plan.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

Recap — Topic 04

1

Lab 16

Define an agent's purpose, boundaries and acceptance tests before any configuration

2

Lab 17

Create an agent, write its instructions and ground it in approved knowledge

3

Lab 18

Extend an agent so it can look up real data and act, not only answer from a document

4

Lab 19

Delegate specialised work from one agent to another and keep the handover accountable

5

Lab 20

Release an agent to real users through a channel and confirm it behaves after publishing

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End of Day 4

See you tomorrow

05

TOPIC 05

Integrating, Testing, Securing and Optimising Agentic Automation

Agent flows · HTTP · JSON schema · RAG · human review · testing · governance

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DAY 5 · WHAT THIS TOPIC COVERS

Key Concepts — Topic 05

1. An agent flow exposes automation to an agent, and an HTTP trigger exposes it to any external application.
2. A JSON schema defines the request contract so an external caller and the flow agree on the data.
3. Structured output turns a model response into named fields a flow can branch on reliably.
4. Retrieval-augmented generation grounds answers in retrieved passages instead of model memory.
5. The boundary of agency decides what an agent may do alone and what needs a person to approve.
6. Testing means verifying correct answers, correct refusals and the run history behind both.

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WHAT YOU WILL DO

Hands-On Labs — Topic 05

Labs 21–22

- Expose a Flow over HTTP with a JSON Schema
- Ground an Agent with Retrieval-Augmented Generation

Labs 23–24

- Add a Human Review Gate to an Agent Action
- Test, Secure and Troubleshoot the Solution

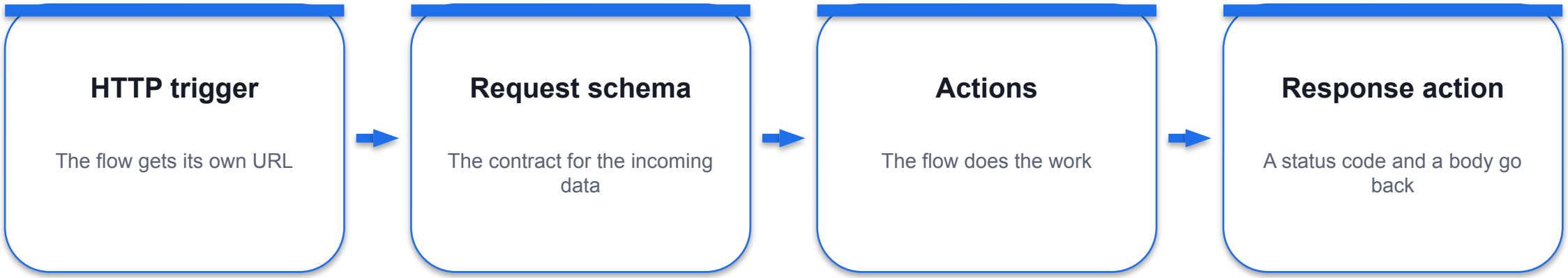
Labs 25–25

- Operate a Governed End-to-End Copilot Pipeline

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INTEGRATION

Exposing Automation Over HTTP



WHY IT MATTERS Without a Response action the caller gets an acknowledgement, not an answer.

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THE CONTRACT

Why a JSON Schema Matters

1

It names the fields

So the caller and the flow agree on the data.

2

It makes them dynamic content

Parsed fields become usable in later steps.

3

It rejects malformed data

A typed contract is a real control.

4

It documents the interface

The schema is the specification.

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SECURITY

The endpoint URL is a credential.

Anyone holding the URL can trigger the flow. Treat it like a password, not like a link.

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BRANCHING ON A MODEL ANSWER

Structured Output

1

Prose is hard to branch on

'It seems approved' is not a value you can test.

2

Structured output returns fields

Named, typed values a condition can read.

3

Define the shape you need

Decision, reason, confidence — whatever you will act on.

4

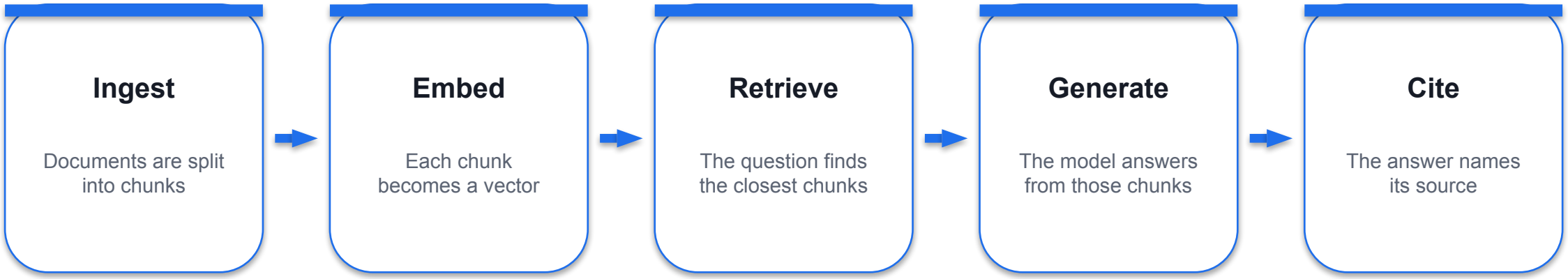
Validate before acting

A field can still arrive empty or unexpected.

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RAG

How Retrieval-Augmented Generation Works



WHY IT MATTERS RAG replaces 'what the model remembers' with 'what the document says'.

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CHOOSING THE APPROACH

Built-In Knowledge vs an External Vector Store

	Built-in knowledge	External vector store
Setup	Upload and go	Ingestion pipeline to build and run
Control	Platform decides chunking	You control chunking and top-k
Scale	Good for a document set	Better for large or changing corpora
Use when	The source is stable and modest	You need control or scale

RULE Start with built-in knowledge. Move to a vector store when you can name the reason.

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THE TEST THAT MATTERS

Probing for Invention

1

Ask about something absent

A course, a price or a policy that does not exist.

2

Ask for a number never stated

A price the documents never give.

3

Ask a leading question

One that presumes a false fact.

4

The only pass is a refusal

A plausible answer here is a failure.

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DECISION RULE

Where Does the Boundary of Agency Sit?



YES

- The agent may act, with an audit row
- Review the audit log regularly

NO

- Require a named person to approve first
- The gate must be one the agent cannot bypass

RULE Rank by consequence, not by how impressive the automation looks.

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CONTROL IN PRACTICE

The Human Review Gate



WHY IT MATTERS Write the audit row regardless of the decision, or your record depends on the answer.

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AUDITABILITY

Log every request, approved or rejected.

A record that only exists when things go well is not a record.

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THREE CAUSES

Diagnosing a Failure

1

Data

The wrong value arrived, or none did. Check the step inputs.

2

Permission

A connection is broken or access was revoked.

3

Configuration

A field is empty, mis-mapped or typed instead of inserted.

4

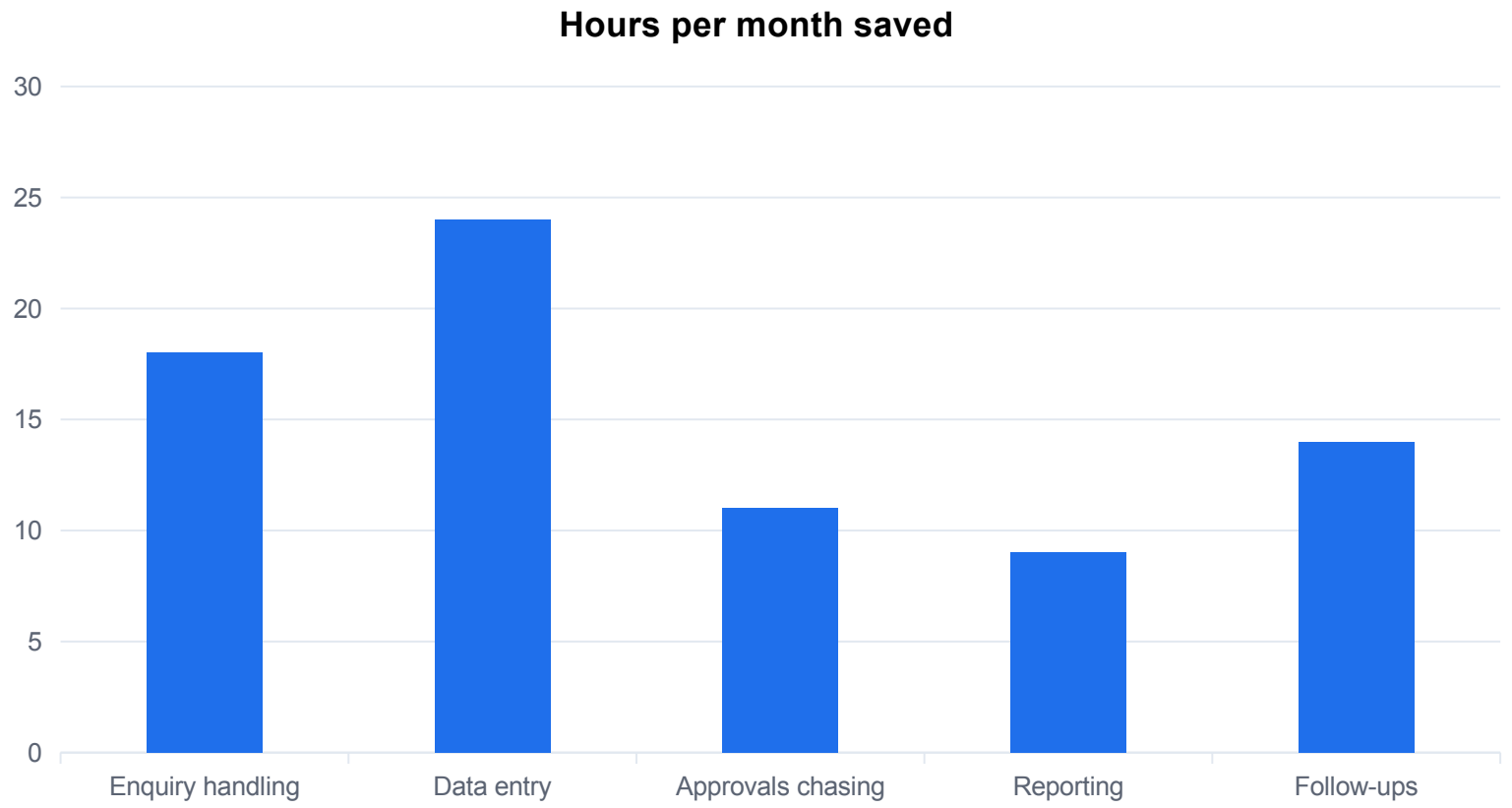
Classify before you fix

Naming the cause is what stops it recurring.

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NATIVE CHART

Where Automation Time Is Recovered



DECISION LENS

Data entry and enquiry handling dominate — which is where the hand-offs were.

? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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AFTER IT WORKS

Optimising a Solution

1

Remove needless steps

Every action is a thing that can fail.

2

Handle the failure path

Decide what happens when a step errors.

3

Watch the run history

Recurring failures are a design signal.

4

Review the boundary

As trust grows, move the gate deliberately, not by drift.

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Tea Break

10 minutes

THE INTERFACE

What an Integration Contract Specifies

1. **The endpoint**
   Where the caller sends the request.

2. **The method and body**
   How the request is shaped.

3. **The schema**
   Which fields are required and their types.

4. **The response**
   Status code and the fields returned.

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INTEGRATION SURFACES

Where Automation Can Be Called From

Caller	Mechanism	Typical use
A person	Instant trigger	A button in an app
Another Microsoft service	Connector trigger	A form, a file, a mail
An external application	HTTP trigger	A website or third-party system
An agent	Tool / agent flow	The agent decides to call it

RULE The same flow logic can be exposed to all four. The trigger is what changes.

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RAG PARAMETERS

Chunking, Embeddings and Top-K

1

Chunk size

Too small loses context; too large dilutes relevance.

2

Overlap

A little overlap stops a fact being split in half.

3

Embeddings

Text becomes vectors so similarity can be measured.

4

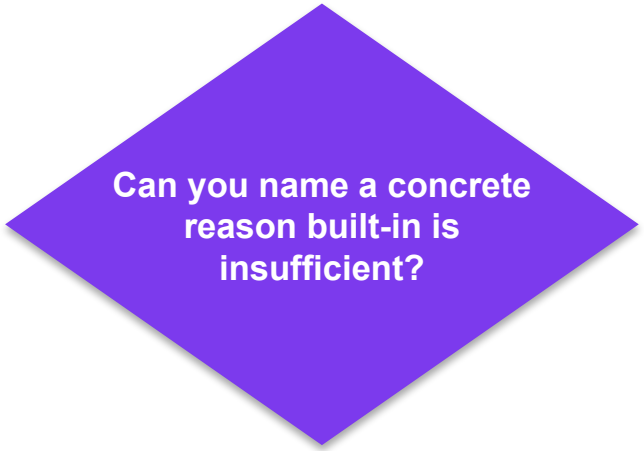
Top-k

How many chunks are retrieved and given to the model.

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DECISION RULE

Built-In Knowledge or an External Vector Store?



YES

- Use the external vector store
- You control chunking, top-k and the index

NO

- Use built-in knowledge
- Less to build, less to run, less to get wrong

RULE Choose the extra machinery when you can articulate why. Not by default.

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GOVERNANCE CHECK

Security Questions to Ask Before Release

1

Who can trigger it?

Especially anything with an HTTP endpoint.

2

What can it reach?

Which systems, and with whose permissions.

3

What is logged?

Enough to reconstruct what happened.

4

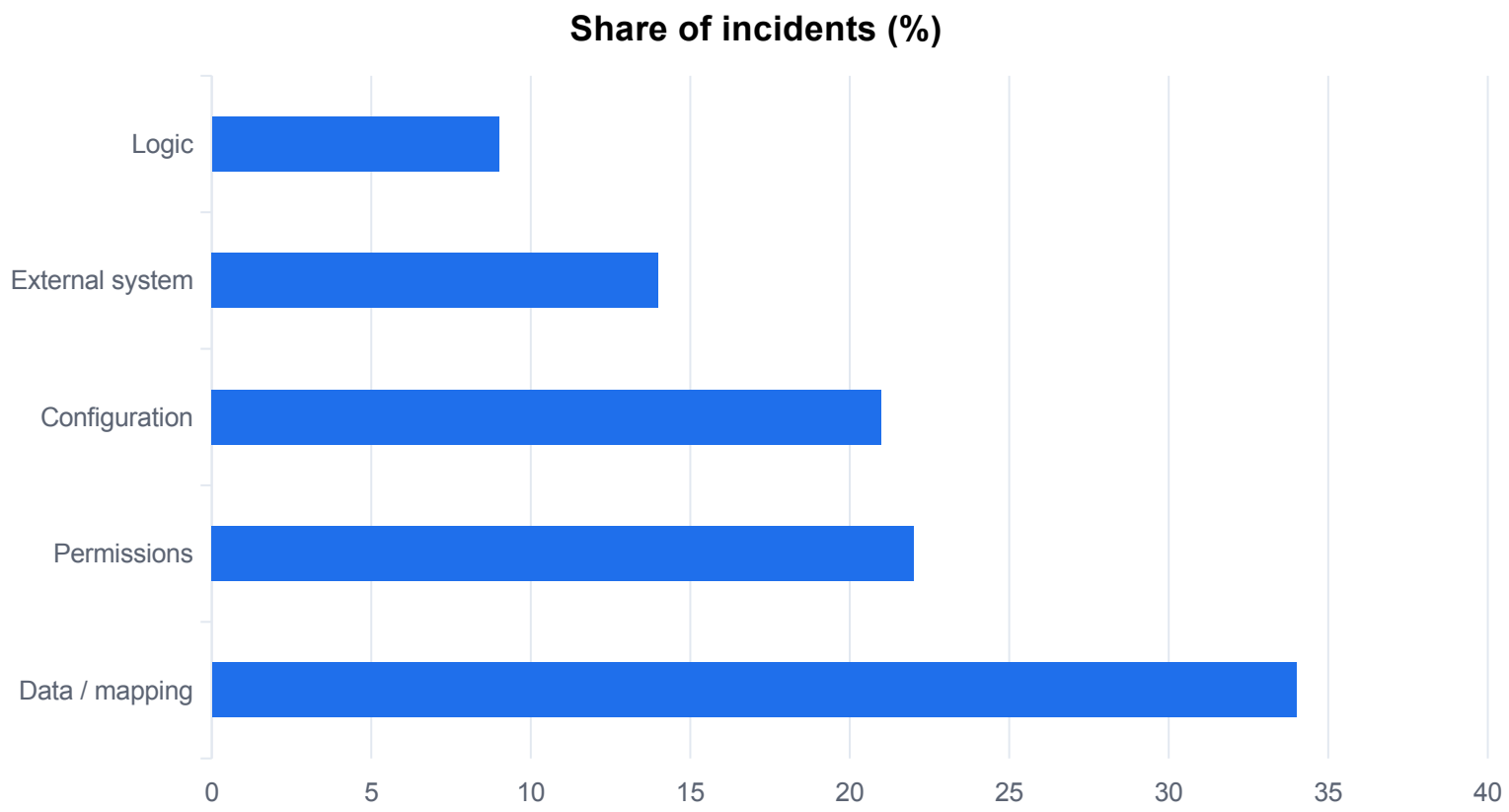
What is the blast radius?

The worst outcome if it behaves incorrectly.

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NATIVE CHART

Failure Causes in Deployed Automations



DECISION LENS

Two thirds are data, permission and configuration — all visible in the run history.

? Check the axis, the units and the source before you act.

Native PowerPoint chart · editable data · verify source and units

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WHEN TO STOP PATCHING

Signs an Automation Needs Redesign

1

The same failure recurs

A pattern is a design signal, not bad luck.

2

Nobody can explain it

Complexity has outrun understanding.

3

Every change breaks something

The steps are too tightly coupled.

4

The gate is routinely bypassed

The control does not fit how people work.

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THE LAST WORD

Move the boundary of agency deliberately.

Trust should be extended by a decision that is recorded — never by drift.

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TOPIC 05 · INTERMEDIATE

Expose a Flow over HTTP with a JSON Schema

LAB 21 K5 · A4

The learner builds a flow with an HTTP request trigger, defines the request body with a JSON schema, returns a structured response, and calls it from outside Power Automate to prove the integration works.

You will build

An HTTP-triggered flow with a defined request schema and a structured JSON response

Apps: Power Automate, HTTP, JSON

ASSESSED K5 · A4

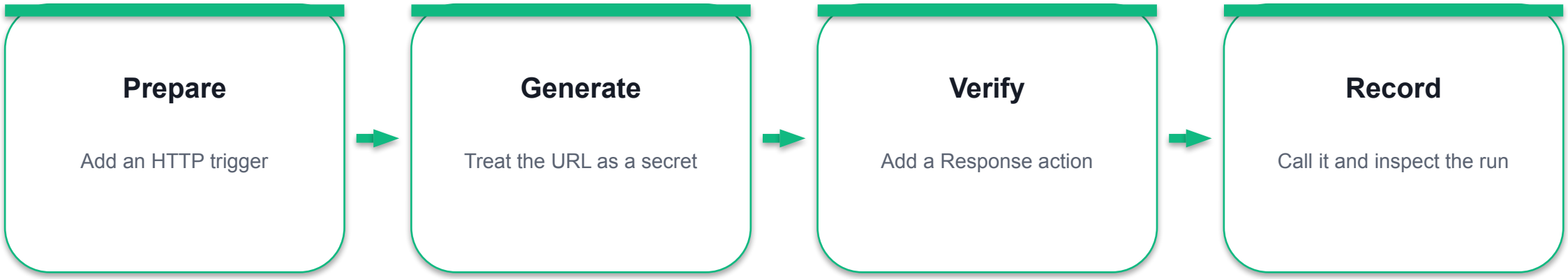
LEVEL Intermediate

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 21 · PROCESS

How Lab 21 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 21) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 21 · ACCEPTANCE

Expose a Flow over HTTP with a JSON Schema

✅ Acceptance check

An external call with a valid body returns the expected JSON response, and the run history shows the parsed fields exactly as the schema defined them.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 05 · ADVANCED

Ground an Agent with Retrieval-Augmented Generation

LAB 22 K5 · A5

The learner grounds an agent in a document set, tests it with questions the documents answer and questions they do not, and probes deliberately for invention to confirm the refusal behaviour holds.

You will build

A retrieval-grounded agent with a documented answer, citation and refusal test set

Apps: Copilot Studio, Knowledge, SharePoint

ASSESSED K5 · A5

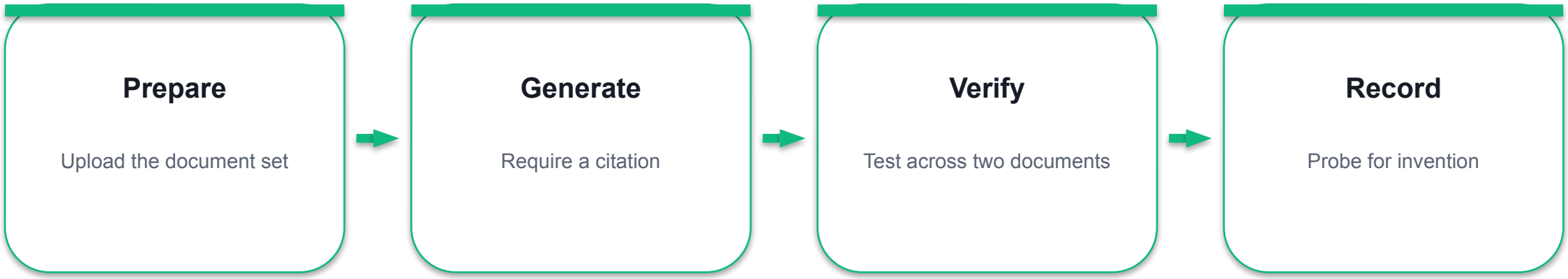
LEVEL Advanced

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 22 · PROCESS

How Lab 22 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 22) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 22 · ACCEPTANCE

Ground an Agent with Retrieval-Augmented Generation

✅ Acceptance check

Every in-scope question is answered with a correct citation, and questions about non-existent courses or unstated prices produce an explicit refusal rather than an invented answer.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 05 · ADVANCED

Add a Human Review Gate to an Agent Action

LAB 23 K5 · A7

The learner takes an agent that can trigger a consequential action and inserts an approval gate, so the model may propose the action but only a named person can release it.

You will build

An agent whose consequential action is suspended until a named person approves it

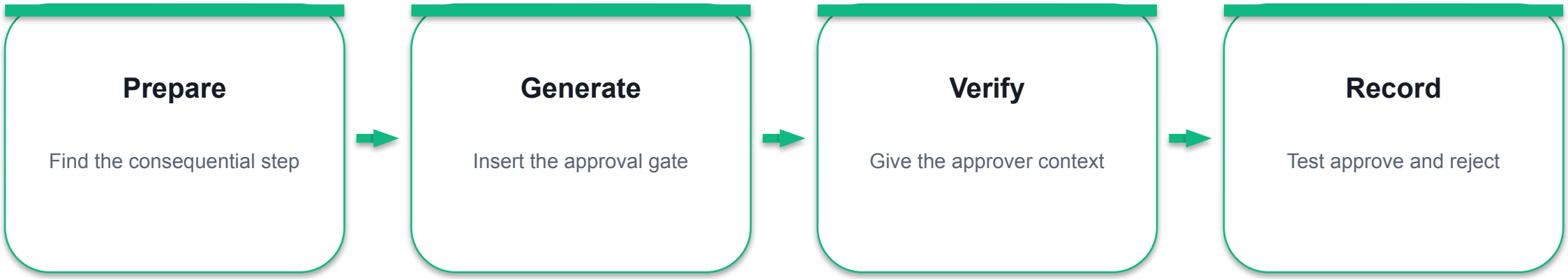
Apps: Copilot Studio, Power Automate, Teams Approvals

ASSESSED	LEVEL	EVIDENCE
K5 · A7	Advanced	Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 23 · PROCESS

How Lab 23 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 23) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 23 · ACCEPTANCE

Add a Human Review Gate to an Agent Action

✅ Acceptance check

The consequential action never completes without a recorded approval, a rejection stops it cleanly, and an audit row exists for every request regardless of outcome.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 05 · ADVANCED

Test, Secure and Troubleshoot the Solution

LAB 24 K5 · A6,A8

The learner runs a structured test pass over the flows and agents built during the course, deliberately triggers failures, reads the run history to diagnose each one, and records the cause and the fix.

You will build

A completed test log and an issue register with a diagnosed cause and fix for every failure

Apps: Power Automate, Copilot Studio, run history

ASSESSED K5 · A6,A8

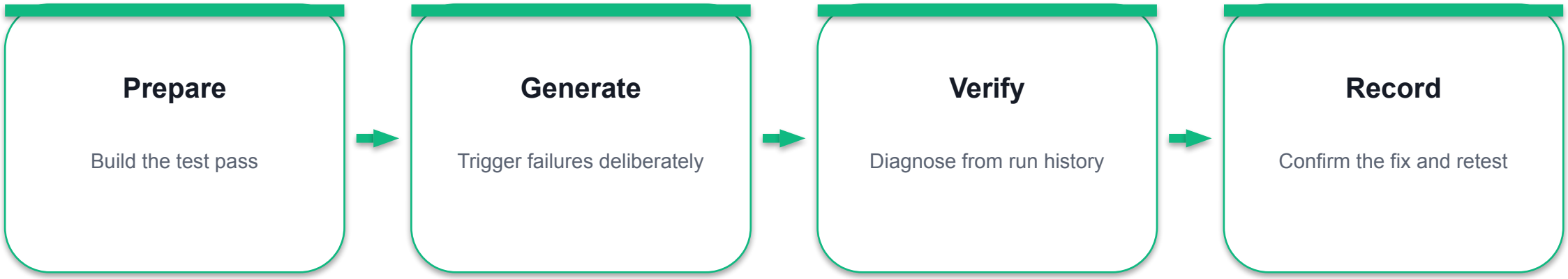
LEVEL Advanced

EVIDENCE Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 24 · PROCESS

How Lab 24 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 24) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 24 · ACCEPTANCE

Test, Secure and Troubleshoot the Solution

✅ Acceptance check

Every flow and agent has a recorded happy-path result, each deliberately triggered failure is diagnosed with a cause and a fix, and every fix has a passing retest.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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TOPIC 05 · CAPSTONE

Operate a Governed End-to-End Copilot Pipeline

LAB 25 K5 · A7,A8

The learner runs one request end to end through the whole solution built during the week, produces the content, routes it through the automation and the human gate, and assembles the governance evidence pack.

You will build

A complete pipeline run with content, automation, approval and a governance evidence pack

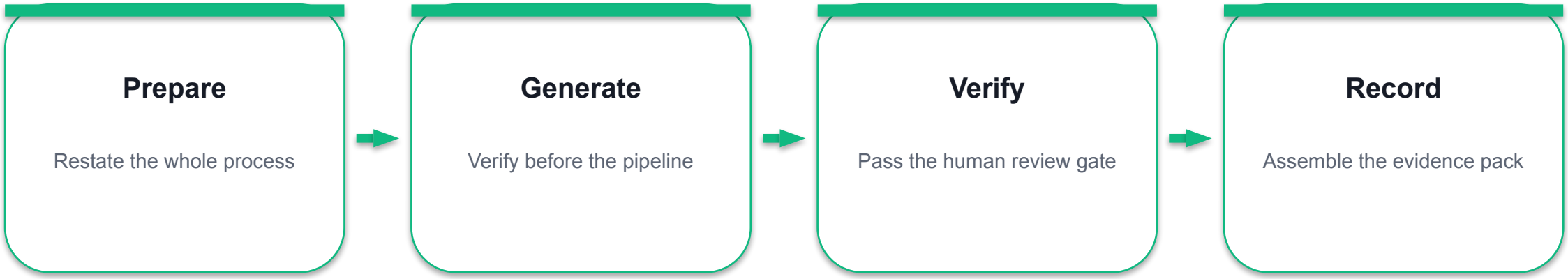
Apps: Microsoft 365 Copilot, Power Automate, Copilot Studio, Outlook, Teams, Excel

ASSESSED K5 · A7,A8	**LEVEL** Capstone	**EVIDENCE** Workbook · screenshot · reviewer

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LAB 25 · PROCESS

How Lab 25 Runs



WHY IT MATTERS The shape of the work. Full step-by-step is in the Learner Guide (Lab 25) and the lab's instruction PDF.

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LAB 25 · ACCEPTANCE

Operate a Governed End-to-End Copilot Pipeline

✅ Acceptance check

One request traverses content generation, verification, automation and human approval, and the evidence pack accounts for every stage with a named owner.

IF IT DOES NOT WORK

Re-read the step inputs before you change anything.

Check the source is attached and the value inserted, not typed.

Full step-by-step: Learner Guide and the lab instruction PDF.

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WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

Recap — Topic 05

1

Lab 21

Integrate an automation with an external application at API level using a defined contract

2

Lab 22

Ground answers in retrieved documents and prove the agent refuses what it cannot find

3

Lab 23

Apply the boundary of agency so a consequential action cannot complete without a person

4

Lab 24

Verify behaviour across platforms and diagnose the technical issues an integration reveals

5

Lab 25

Run the complete pipeline from request to verified output with governance evidence

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WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

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LEARNING OUTCOMES

What You Achieved

1. **Copilot for content**
   Verified business content in Word, PowerPoint, Excel and Outlook.

2. **Feasibility scanning**
   Identified and scoped automation opportunities.

3. **Power Automate**
   Built flows with triggers, actions, conditions and approvals.

4. **Copilot Studio agents**
   Designed, grounded, tooled, orchestrated and published agents.

5. **Integration**
   Connected automation over HTTP with a JSON schema.

6. **Testing and governance**
   Tested behaviour, gated actions and diagnosed failures.

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NEXT STEPS

Taking This Back to Work

1. **Start with one process**
   Pick something repetitive, rule-based and time-consuming.

2. **Write the prompt contract**
   Goal, context, source, expectation — every time.

3. **Ground before you trust**
   An answer with no source is a draft, not a fact.

4. **Gate the consequential step**
   Decide the boundary of agency before you build.

5. **Keep the evidence**
   Prompt log, evidence register and run history.

6. **Review the run history**
   Recurring failures are telling you about the design.

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Assessment

	Written Assessment (WA)	Practical Performance (PP)
Format	Short-answer questions (SAQ)	Hands-on practical tasks
What it tests	Underpinning knowledge K1-K5	Practical ability A1-A8
Duration	1 hour	1 hour
Conditions	Open book, individual	Open book, individual
Submission	On the LMS	On the LMS, with evidence

RULE Open book: slides, Learner Guide and your completed lab files. 75% attendance is required; a re-assessment and appeal process is available.

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow

1. TRAQOM survey — scan the QR code on the LMS
2. Assessment digital attendance — scan the SSG QR
3. Sit WA (SAQ) then PP — open book
4. Submit your answers on the LMS
5. Sign the Assessment Summary Record

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1. Trainer displays the SSG digital attendance QR code
2. Scan it with your phone camera
3. Submit your attendance
4. Repeat AM, PM and on assessment day

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SEE YOU IN CLASS

Thank You!

You can now create verified content with Copilot and automate the process behind it.

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